Scope of Service

When using the list, please note that columns 3, 4, and 5 do not stand alone. Additional information contained in columns 4 and 5 may include topics or certification levels that affect whether volunteers may or may not prepare the return under the provisions of the Volunteer Protection Act.

If no certification level is listed, the topic is in scope for all certification levels.

Many forms and schedules that are out of scope are included as reference. If a form or schedule is not listed, it is out of scope because no training has been provided. In addition, if a volunteer has not been trained on an in-scope tax law topic, that topic is out of scope for that volunteer.

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 1040	1	Yes	Wages, salaries, tips, etc.	Advanced certification required for unreported tip income.
F 1040	2a, b	Yes	Tax-exempt and taxable interest See F 1099-INT for limitations	
F 1040	3a, b	Yes	Qualified and Ordinary dividends See F 1099-DIV for limitations	
F 1040	4a, b, c, d	Yes	IRAs, pensions and annuities See F 1099-R for limitations • Foreign retirement arrangements that may need special reporting on FINCEN 114 or F 8938	Basic certification if taxable amount is determined. Advanced certification required if taxable amount is **NOT** determined.
F 1040	5a, b	Yes	Social Security benefits **Not in scope for:** • Foreign social security from Canada or Germany that is treated as U.S. Social Security	
F 1040	6	Yes	Capital gain or loss. See F 8949 limitations	Advanced certification required.
F 1040	9	Yes	Standard deduction or Itemized deductions See F 1040 Schedule A limitations	Advanced certification required for itemized deductions.
F 1040	10	Yes	Qualified Business Income deduction **In scope for:** • The 20% deduction for sole proprietors and taxpayers with qualifying REIT dividends **Not in scope for:** • Taxable income over $160,700 ($321,400 if MFJ) • Publicly traded partnership income	
F 1040	12a	Yes	Tax See Schedule 2 for limitations	
F 1040	13a	Yes	Child tax credit/credit for other dependents	
F 1040	15	Yes	Other taxes See limitations on Schedule 2	
F 1040	17	Yes	Federal income tax withheld from Forms W-2 and 1099	
F 1040	18a, b, c, and d	Yes	Other payments and refundable credits (EIC, Additional child tax credit, American opportunity credit) See Schedule 3 for limitations	
F 1040	21a, b, c, and d	Yes	Direct deposit of refund See also F 8888	
F 1040	22	Yes	Refund applied to 2020 estimated tax	
F 1040	23	Yes	Amount you owe	
F 1040	24	No	Estimated tax penalty	
F 1040-ES		Yes	Estimated Tax for Individuals	
F 1040-NR F 1040-NR-EZ		Yes	U.S. Nonresident Alien Income Tax Return **In scope (with Foreign Student certification only) for:** • Students on F, J, M, or Q Visa • Teacher or trainee on J Visa **Not in scope for:** • Individuals having a dual status for the tax year • Nonresident aliens who do not meet the green card or substantial presence test and are not married to a U.S. citizen or resident alien	**Foreign Student certification required**

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 1040-PR		Yes	Self-Employment Tax Return – Puerto Rico (in Spanish)	**Puerto Rico certification required**
F 1040-SR		Yes	U.S. Income Tax Return for Seniors See limitations for F 1040	
F 1040-SS		Yes	U.S. Self-Employment Tax Return (Including the Additional Child Tax Credit for Bona Fide Residents of Puerto Rico)	**Puerto Rico certification required**
F 1040-X		Yes	Amended U.S. Individual Income Tax Return **Not in scope for:** • Original return was out of scope and is not brought into scope by the amendment • Taxpayers who may qualify for an exception to the three-year time limit for filing an amended return except for applying for standard refund of tax on military disability payments	Advanced certification required
F W-2		Yes	Wage and Tax Statement See F 8615 limitations for children with unearned income **Not in scope for:** • Box 12 codes: - Q **(Military certification required. Active duty military taxpayer returns only)** - R, T - FF if premium tax credits are involved - W **(HSA certification required)** • Ministers • Other members of the clergy who present issues such as: parsonage/housing allowance, whether earnings are covered under FICA or Self-Employed Contributions Act (SECA) or rules for determining exemption from coverage	All certification levels **International certification required** for foreign employer compensation
F W-2G		Yes	Certain Gambling Winnings **Not in scope for:** • Professional gamblers who use Schedule C	
F W-7		Yes	Application for IRS Individual Taxpayer Identification Number	
S 1	1	Yes	Taxable refunds, credits or offsets of state or local income taxes **Not in scope for:** • Refund for other than previous tax year	
S 1	2a, b	Yes	Alimony received **Not in scope for:** • Pre-1985 divorces	
S 1	3	Yes	Business income or loss See Schedule C limitations	Advanced certification required
S 1	4	No	Other gains or (losses)	
S 1	5	Yes	Rental real estate, royalties, partnerships, S corporations, trusts, etc. See Schedule E limitations	**Military certification required**
S 1	6	No	Farm income or (loss)	
S 1	7	Yes	Unemployment compensation	
S 1	8	Yes	Other income See F 1099-MISC, F 1099-PATR, F 1099-Q, F 1099-QA, F 1099-SA, F 982 and F 2555 for limitations **In scope for:** • Cancellation of nonbusiness credit card debt • Discharge of qualified principal residence indebtedness (if extended) **Not in scope for:** • Cancellation of other debt income • Rental, hobby or other income when “not for profit” • Net operating loss deduction	Advanced certification required for discharge of principal residence indebtedness **International certification required** for foreign earned income exclusion
S 1	10	Yes	Educator expenses	
S 1	11	Yes	Certain business expenses of reservists, performing artists and fee-basis government officials. See F 2106 limitations	**Military certification required**
S 1	12	Yes	Health saving account deduction See F 8889 limitations	**HSA certification required**
S 1	13	Yes	Moving expenses for members of the Armed Forces See F 3903 limitations	**Military certification required**
S 1	14	Yes	Deductible part of self-employment tax	Advanced certification required
S 1	15	No	Self-employed SEP, SIMPLE and qualified plans	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
S 1	16	Yes	Self-employed health insurance deduction See Schedule C for limitations **Not in scope for:** • Insurance purchased through Marketplace when taxpayer is eligible for Premium Tax Credit	Advanced certification required
S 1	17	Yes	Penalty on early withdrawal of savings	
S 1	18a, b, and c	Yes	Alimony paid **Not in scope for:** • Pre-1985 divorces	
S 1	19	Yes	IRA deduction **In scope for:** • Deductible IRA contributions **Not in scope for:** • Nondeductible IRA contributions (except for Roth IRAs)	Advanced certification required
S 1	20	Yes	Student loan interest deduction	
S 1	21	Yes	Tuition and fees deduction (if extended)	
S 2	1	No	Alternative minimum tax	
S 2	2	Yes	Excess advance premium tax credit repayment See F 8962 limitations	Advanced certification required
S 2	4	Yes	Self-employment tax	Advanced certification required
S 2	5	Yes	Unreported Social Security and Medicare tax **In scope for:** • F 4137 **Not in scope for:** • F 8919	Advanced certification required
S 2	6	Yes	Additional tax on IRAs, other qualified retirement plans, and other tax-favored accounts See F 5329 for limitations **Not in scope for:** • Taxpayers subject to additional tax due to excess IRA contributions	Basic certification if additional tax applies Advanced certification required if exceptions to the additional tax apply
S 2	7a	No	Household employment taxes	
S 2	7b	Yes	Repayment of first-time homebuyer credit from Form 5405 See F 5405 for limitations	
S 2	8	Yes	Taxes from F 8959, F 8960 (and other forms, including F 8889 HSA) See F 8889 limitations **Not in scope for:** • F 8959 or F 8960	**HSA certification required**
S 2	9	No	Section 965 net tax liability installment from F 965-A	
S 3	1	Yes	Foreign tax credit See F 1116 for limitations	Advanced certification required for FTC without F 1116 **International certification required for F 1116**
S 3	2	Yes	Credit for child and dependent care expenses	
S 3	3	Yes	Education credits **Not in scope for:** • Taxpayers who must repay (recapture) part or all of an education credit claimed in a prior year	
S 3	4	Yes	Retirement savings contribution credit	
S 3	5	Yes	Residential energy credit (if extended) See F 5695 for limitations	Advanced certification required
S 3	6a, b, and c	Yes	Other credits from F 3800, 8801, and (write-in) • Box c is in scope for Schedule R **Not in scope for:** • Boxes a and b	
S 3	8	Yes	2019 estimated tax payments and amount applied from 2018 return	
S 3	9	Yes	Net premium tax credit See F 8962 for limitations	Advanced certification required
S 3	10	Yes	Amount paid with request for extension to file	
S 3	11	Yes	Excess Social Security and tier 1 RRTA tax withheld	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
S 3	12	No	Credit for federal tax on fuels	
S 3	13	No	Credits from Forms 2439, 8885 (and other tax payments)	
S A		Yes	Itemized Deductions **Not in scope for:** • Investment interest • Taxpayers affected by a charitable contribution carryover • Taxpayers affected by limits on charitable deductions • F 8283 (noncash contribution exceeding $500) • Form 1098-C, Contributions of Motor Vehicles, Boats and Airplanes • Donation of property previously depreciated • Donation of capital gain property (appreciable properties such as securities or art work) • Casualty or theft losses	Advanced certification required
S B		Yes	Interest and Ordinary Dividends See FinCEN F 114, F 3520 and F 8938 for limitations See F 1099-INT, F 1099-DIV, and F 1099-OID for limitations	
S C		Yes	Profit or Loss from Business (Sole Proprietorship) See F 1099-K for limitations See F 1099-MISC for limitations **Not in scope for:** • Hobby income or not for profit activity • Professional gamblers • Bartering • Any transactions involving virtual currency (bitcoins) • Method of accounting other than cash • Taxpayers who do not materially participate in the business • Payments made that require F 1099 to be filed • Returns and allowances • Cost of goods sold (inventory) • Total expenses over $25,000 • Vehicle expenses reported as actual expenses • Contract labor • Depletion • Depreciation or when F 4562 is required • Expenses for employees • Car rental or lease more than 30 days (use standard mileage rate method only) • Casualty losses, amortization • Business use of home • Net losses	Advanced certification required
S D		Yes	Capital Gains and Losses See F 8949 for limitations See F 1099-B for limitations **Not in scope for:** Lines 4 and 11 • Taxpayers who sold any assets other than stock, mutual funds, or a personal residence • Taxpayers who trade in options, futures, or other commodities, whether or not they disposed of any during the year • Taxpayers who have transactions using Bitcoins or other virtual currencies • Determination of basis issues: - Basis of any asset acquired other than by purchase or inheritance, such as a gift or employee stock option, unless the taxpayer provides the basis and holding period - Basis of inherited property determined by a method other than the FMV of the property on the date of the decedent's death, unless the taxpayer provides the basis and holding period • Like-kind exchanges and worthless securities • Reduced exclusion computations/determinations for the sale of a home • Married homeowners who do not meet all requirements to claim the maximum exclusion on the sale of a home • Decreases to basis, including deductible casualty losses and gains a taxpayer postponed from the sale of a previous home before May 7, 1997 • Depreciation during the time the home was used for business purposes or as rental property • Taxpayers with "nonqualified use" issues • Sale of a home used for business purposes or as rental property	Advanced certification required

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
S E		Yes	Supplemental Income and Loss (Rental) See F 1099-MISC and S K-1 for limitations **In scope for:** • Royalties reported on Form 1099-MISC, if there are no associated expenses (Advanced) • Certain income from Schedules K-1 (Forms 1065, 1120S, and 1041) (Advanced) • Home rental (including Part I, lines 5-19) **if military certified** and taxpayer is active duty military • Rental of personal residence for less than 15 days for the year is not considered a rental activity and is not taxable income (Advanced) unless taxpayer is in the rental business or cleaning, linen, food or similar services were provided during the rental period (out of scope) **Not in scope for:** • Rental income and expenses for nonmilitary taxpayers • Taxpayers who rent their property at less than fair rental value • Rental-related interest expenses other than mortgage interest • The actual expense method (auto and travel expense deductions) • Casualty loss • Completing Form 8582 if volunteers are required to enter additional data in Form 8582 in the software • Completing Form 4562 • Taxpayers who are unable to provide an amount for depreciation • Taxpayers who filed or need to file Form(s) 1099	Advanced certification required for royalties reported on Form 1099-MISC and Schedule K-1 **Military certification required for rental income**
S EIC		Yes	Earned Income Credit	
S F		No	Profit or Loss From Farming	
S H		No	Household Employment Taxes	
S J		No	Income Averaging for Farmers and Fishermen	
S K-1		Yes	Beneficiary, Partner or Shareholder's Share of Income, Deductions, Credits, etc. **In scope for:** • Schedules K-1 (Forms 1065, 1120S, and 1041). - Taxable and tax-exempt interest income - Dividend and Qualified dividends income - Net short- and long-term capital gains and losses - Royalty income (Schedule E) with no associated expenses **Not in scope for:** • Other income, deductions, and credits not listed above	Advanced certification required
S Q (F 1066)		No	Quarterly Notice to Resident Interest Holder of REMIC Taxable Income or Net Loss Allocation	
S R		Yes	Credit for the Elderly or the Disabled	
S SE		Yes	Self-Employment Tax **Not in scope for:** • Ministers or church workers if special rules apply	
S 8812		Yes	Additional Child Tax Credit	
F T (Timber)		No	Forest Activities Schedule	
F 56		No	Notice Concerning Fiduciary Relationship	
F 709		No	United States Gift (and Generation-Skipping Transfer) Tax Return	
F 843		No	Claim for refund and request for abatement	
F 982		Yes	Reduction of Tax Attributes Due to Discharge of Indebtedness (and Section 1082 Base Adjustment) – (if extended) **In scope for:** • Line 1e • Line 2 • Line 10b **Not in scope for:** • Issues other than discharge of qualified principal residence indebtedness • Principal residence used in business or as rental property • Taxpayer filed bankruptcy or was insolvent immediately before the debt was canceled	Advanced certification required
F 1040-C		No	U.S. Departing Alien Income Tax Return	
F 1045		No	Application for Tentative Refund	
F 1066 (Sch Q)		No	Quarterly Notice to Resident Interest Holder of REMIC Taxable Income or Net Loss Allocation	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 1095-A		Yes	Health Insurance Marketplace Statement	Advanced certification required
F 1095-B		Yes	Health Coverage	
F 1095-C		Yes	Employer Provided Health Insurance Offer and Coverage	
F 1098		Yes	Mortgage Interest Statement	Advanced certification required
F 1098-C		No	Contributions of Motor Vehicles, Boats, Airplanes	
F 1098-E		Yes	Student Loan Interest Statement	
F 1098-MA		No	Mortgage Assistance Payments	
F 1098-Q		Yes	Qualifying Longevity Annuity Contract Information (information only) No tax reporting required.	
F 1098-T		Yes	Tuition Statement **Not in scope for:** • Boxes 4 and 6 (Adjustments)	
F 1099-A		Yes	Acquisition or Abandonment of Secured Property See F 982 for limitations **In scope for:** • Qualified principal residence (if extended)	Advanced certification required
F 1099-B		Yes	Proceeds from Broker and Barter Exchange Transactions **Not in scope for:** • FATCA filing requirement box checked • Boxes 1f and 7-11, 13	Advanced certification required
F 1099-C		Yes	Cancellation of Debt See F 982 for limitations **In scope for:** • Nonbusiness credit card debt cancellation including interest in box 3 when taxpayer is solvent before the cancellation • Discharge of qualified principal residence indebtedness (if extended) **Not in scope for:** • Cancellation of debt when Form 1099-C includes an amount for interest (exception listed above)	Advanced certification required
F 1099-CAP		Yes	Changes in Corporate Control and Capital Structure (information only) No tax reporting required.	
F 1099-DIV		Yes	Dividends and Distributions **Not in scope for:** • Boxes labeled Unrecap Sec. 1250 gain, Section 1202 gain, Cash liquidation distributions, and Noncash liquidation distributions • 2d Collectibles (28%) gain • FATCA filing requirement box checked	
F 1099-G		Yes	Certain Government Payments **In scope for:** • Unemployment compensation • Refunds, credits, or offsets of state or local income tax **Not in scope for:** • Box 3 is other than the current tax year • Boxes 7-9	
F 1099-H		No	Health Coverage Tax Credit	
F 1099-INT		Yes	Interest Income See F 8615 for limitations (children with unearned income) **Not in scope for:** • Taxpayer is a nominee • An adjustment is needed to any amount reported • Amounts reported in the box labeled Specified private activity bond interest if AMT applies • Amounts reported in the box labeled Bond premium that exceed amounts reported in the box labeled Interest • FATCA filing requirement box checked • Accrued bond interest other than for savings bonds • Bonds bought or sold between interest payment dates other than for savings bonds	
F 1099-K		Yes	Payment Card and Third Party Network Transactions **Not in scope for:** • Any adjustment to amount reported on F 1099-K	Advanced certification required

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 1099-LTC		Yes	Long-Term Care and Accelerated Death Benefits	Advanced certification required
F 1099-MISC		Yes	Miscellaneous Income **Not in scope for:** • Box 5 Fishing boat proceeds • Boxes 8-15 • FATCA filing requirement box checked	Military certification required for Box 1 Basic certification required for Box 3 Advanced certification required for all other entries
F 1099-OID		Yes	Original Issue Discount **Not in scope for:** • FATCA filing requirement box checked • Box 6 Acquisition premium • Adjustment needed, or no form received	
F 1099-PATR		Yes	Taxable Distributions Received From Cooperatives **In scope for:** • Box 1 for personal use only	Advanced certification required
F 1099-Q		Yes	Payment From Qualified Education Programs (under section 529 and 530) **Not in scope for:** • Distributions from Educational Savings Accounts if: - Funds were not used for qualified education expenses or - Distribution was more than the amount of the qualified expenses	
F 1099-QA		Yes	Distribution from ABLE Account **Not in scope for:** • Distribution from ABLE Account that was more than the amount of the qualified expenses	
F 1099-R F CSA 1099-R		Yes	Distributions from Pensions, Annuities, Retirement or Profit-Sharing Plans, IRAs, Insurance Contracts, etc. **Not in scope for:** • IRA rollovers that do not meet the tax-free requirements • Taxpayers who used the General Rule to figure the taxable portion of pensions and/or annuities for past years • Box 7 code 2, if the IRA/SEP/SIMPLE box is checked and there were nondeductible contributions • Box 7 codes 5, 6, 8, 9, A, E, J, K, N, P, R, T, U, W	Basic certification if taxable amount is determined Advanced certification required if taxable amount is NOT determined
F RRB-1099		Yes	Payments by the Railroad Retirement Board Annuities or Pensions by the Railroad Retirement Board	Advanced certification required
F 1099-S		Yes	Proceeds from Real Estate Transactions **In scope for:** • Personal residence **Not in scope for:** • Home was used for rental purposes • Sales of business property • Installment sales income • Like-kind exchanges	Advanced certification required
F 1099-SA		Yes	Distributions From an HSA, Archer MSA or Medicare Advantage MSA See F 8889 for limitations **Not in scope for:** • Archer MSA • Medicare Advantage MSA	HSA certification required
F SSA-1099		Yes	Social Security Benefit Statement	
F 1116		Yes	Foreign Tax Credit (Individual, Estate or Trust) **In scope for:** • Taxpayers who have foreign tax paid reported on F 1099-INT, F 1099-DIV, or S K-1 and can elect to report foreign tax without filing Form 1116 (Advanced certification) **Not in scope for:** • Taxpayers who may deduct a foreign income tax that is not allowed as a credit in certain circumstances • Certain expenses deducted to reduce foreign gross income • Taxpayers who must report a carryback or carryover on Form 1116 • Taxpayers who must file a separate Form 1116 required for foreign income from a sanctioned country, using the “Section 901(j) income” category	**International certification required** for F 1116
F 1127		No	Extension of Time for Payment of Tax Due to Undue Hardship	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 2106		Yes	Employee Business Expenses **In scope for:** • Reservist expenses (adjustment to gross income) • U.S. Armed Forces members who were provided a commuter highway vehicle (such as a van) by their employer	**Military certification required**
F 2120		Yes	Multiple Support Declaration	
F 2210		No	Underpayment of Estimated Tax by Individuals, Estates and Trusts	
F 2439		No	Notice to Shareholder of Undistributed Long-Term Capital Gains	
F 2441		Yes	Child and Dependent Care Expenses **Out of scope for:** • Taxpayers who need assistance in determining if employment taxes are owed for household employees	
F 2555		Yes	Foreign Earned Income	**International certification required**
F 2848		Yes	Power of Attorney and Declaration of Representative (Very limited uses in form instructions)	
F 3468		No	Investment Credit	
F 3520		No	Foreign Trusts/Foreign Gifts	
F 3800		No	General Business Credit	
F 3903		Yes	Moving Expenses **In scope for:** • Active duty military taxpayer only	**Military certification required**
F 4136		No	Credit for Federal Tax Paid on Fuels	
F 4137		Yes	Social Security and Medicare Taxes on Unreported Tip Income	Advanced certification required
F 4562		No	Depreciation and Amortization (including information on listed property)	
F 4684		No	Casualties and Thefts	
F 4797		No	Sales of Business Property	
F 4835		No	Farm Rental Income and Expenses	
F 4852		Yes	Substitute for F W-2 or F 1099-R	
F 4868		Yes	Application for Automatic Extension of Time to File U.S. Individual Income Tax Return	
F 4952		No	Investment Interest Expense Deduction	
F 4972		No	Tax on Lump-Sum Distributions	
F 5329		Yes	Additional Tax on Qualified Plans (including IRAs) and Other Tax-Favored Accounts **In scope for:** • Part I **Not in scope for:** • IRA minimum distributions not withdrawn when required • Excess contributions to an IRA that are not withdrawn by the due date of the return including extensions • Parts II through IX	Advanced certification required
F 5405		Yes	Repayment of the First-Time Homebuyer Credit **Not in scope for:** • Taxpayers who claimed credit and their home is destroyed, condemned or disposed of under threat of condemnation • Taxpayers who claimed the first-time homebuyer credit may be required to repay the credit in the year of sale. The repayment is limited to the amount of gain on the sale. This situation is out of scope for VITA/TCE.	Advanced certification required
F 5498		Yes	IRA Contribution Information **Not in scope for:** • SEP or SIMPLE contributions • Nondeductible contributions	Advanced certification required
F 5498-ESA		Yes	Coverdell ESA Contribution Information (Information only) No tax reporting required	
F 5498-QA		Yes	ABLE Account Contribution Information (Information only) No tax reporting required	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 5498-SA		Yes	HSA, Archer MSA or Medicare Advantage MSA Information **Not in scope for:** • Archer MSA • Medicare Advantage MSA	**HSA certification required**
F 5695		Yes	Residential Energy Credit – (if extended) **Not in scope for:** • Resident Energy Efficient Property Credit (Part I)	Advanced certification required
F 6251		Yes	Alternative Minimum Tax **In scope for:** • Interest from private activity bond on Line 12 **Out of scope if AMT applies**	
F 6252		No	Installment Sales Income	
F 6781		No	Gains and Losses From Section 1256 Contracts and Straddles	
F 8275		No	Disclosure Statement	
F 8275 R		No	Regulation Disclosure Statement	
F 8283		No	Noncash Charitable Contributions Noncash contributions of $500 or less are reported on Schedule A and are in scope	
F 8332		Yes	Release/Revocation of Release of Claim to Exemption for Child by Custodial Parent	
F 8379		Yes	Injured Spouse Allocation See F 8958 limitations (community property states)	
F 8396		No	Mortgage Interest Credit	
F 8453		Yes	U.S. Individual Income Tax Transmittal for an IRS e-file Return	
F 8582		No	Passive Activity Loss Limitations	
F 8606		No	Nondeductible IRAs	
F 8615		Yes	Tax for Certain Children Who Have Unearned Income (also known as Kiddie Tax) **In scope for:** • Students electing to include unearned income such as scholarships/grants as income on the return **Out of scope if taxpayer elects to use parent's tax rates**	
F 8621		No	Information Return by A Shareholder of a Passive Foreign Investment Company or Qualified Electing Fund	
F 8801		No	Credit for Prior Year Minimum Tax	
F 8805		No	Foreign Partner's Information Statement of Section 1446 Withholding Tax	
S 8812		Yes	Additional Child Tax Credit	
F 8814		No	Parent's Election to Report Child's Interest and Dividends	
F 8815		No	Exclusion of Interest From Series EE and I U.S. Savings Bonds Issued after 1989	
F 8821		No	Tax Information Authorization	
F 8829		No	Expenses for Business Use of Your Home	
F 8833		No	Treaty-Based Return Positive Disclosure Under Section 6114 or 7701 (b)	
F 8834		No	Plug-In Electric Vehicle Credit	
F 8839		No	Qualified Adoption Expenses	
F 8848		No	Consent to Extend the Time to Access the Branch Profits Tax Under Regulations Section 1.884-2 (a) and (c)	
F 8853		Yes	Archer MSAs and Long-Term Care Insurance Contracts **In scope for:** • Section C	
F 8857		No	Request for Innocent Spouse Relief	
F 8862		Yes	Information to Claim Earned Income Credit After Disallowance	
F 8863		Yes	Education Credits (American Opportunity and Lifetime Learning Credits)	
F 8865		No	Return of U.S. Persons With Respect to Certain Foreign Partnerships	
F 8880		Yes	Credit for Qualified Retirement Savings Contributions	
F 8885		No	Health Coverage Tax Credit	
F 8886		No	Reportable Transaction Disclosure Statement	
F 8888		Yes	Allocation of Refund (Including Savings Bond Purchases)	

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 8889		Yes	Health Savings Accounts (HSAs) **Not in scope for:** • Excess contributions to an HSA that are not withdrawn in a timely fashion • Qualified HSA funding distributions from an IRA • Death of an HSA holder (when spouse is not the designated beneficiary) • Additional Tax for Failure to Maintain HDHP Coverage • Deemed distributions from an HSA due to prohibited transactions, such as using an HSA as a security for a loan • Archer Medical Saving Accounts (MSA) • Medicare Advantage MSA • Health Reimbursement Arrangement • Part III, lines 18-21	**HSA certification required**
F 8903		No	Domestic Production Activities Deduction	
F 8908		No	Energy Efficient Home Credit	
F 8910		No	Alternate Motor Vehicle Credit	
F 8911		No	Alternative Fuel Vehicle Refueling Property Credit	
F 8915-A		No	Qualified 2016 Disaster Retirement Plan Distributions and Repayments	
F 8915-B		No	Qualified 2017 Disaster Retirement Plan Distributions and Repayments	
F 8917		Yes	Tuition and Fees Deduction (if extended)	
F 8919		No	Uncollected Social Security and Medicare Tax on Wages	
F 8936		No	Qualified Plug-in Electric Drive Motor Vehicle Credit	
F 8938		No	Statement of Specified Foreign Assets	
F 8948		No	Preparer Explanation for Not Filing Electronically • Not applicable to volunteers	
F 8949		Yes	Sales and other Dispositions of Capital Assets **In scope for:** • Sale of stocks, mutual fund shares and personal residences • Bond sales reported on a brokerage statement with capital gain or loss only (no ordinary income/loss) • Capital gains and losses reported on K-1 • Capital loss carryovers • Inherited property of types listed above in this section and, if inherited in 2010, taxpayer provides the basis • Wash sales if reported on brokerage or mutual fund statement **Not in scope for:** • Adjustment codes N, Q, X, R, S or C • Reduced exclusion on sale of home • Residence inherited or received as gift and not used as personal residence. If used as personal residence, taxpayer must provide basis. • Taxpayers who have sold any assets other than stock, mutual funds, or a personal residence • Taxpayers who trade in options, futures, or other commodities, whether or not they disposed of any during the year • Determination of basis issues: - Basis of any asset acquired other than by purchase or inheritance, such as a gift or employee stock option, unless the taxpayer provides the basis and holding period - Basis of inherited property determined by a method other than the FMV of the property on the date of the decedent's death, unless the taxpayer provides the basis and holding period • Like-kind exchanges and worthless securities • Form 1099-B, boxes with entries for any of the following: Bartering; Profit or (loss) realized on closed contracts; Unrealized profit (loss) on open contracts – prior year; Unrealized profit or (loss) on open contracts – current year; or Aggregate profit (loss) on contracts; Proceeds from collectibles; or FATCA filing requirement • Reduced exclusion computations/determinations for the sale of a home • Married homeowners who do not meet all requirements to claim the maximum exclusion on the sale of a home • Decreases to basis, including: Deductible casualty losses and gains a taxpayer postponed from the sale of a previous home before May 7, 1997 • Depreciation during the time the home was used for business purposes or as rental property • Taxpayers with "nonqualified use" issues • Sale of a home used for business purposes or as rental property	Advanced certification required

F(orm) S(chedule) #	Line / Box #	In Scope? Y / N	Scope Limitations	Certification Levels
F 8958		Yes	Allocation of Tax Amounts Between Certain Individuals in Community Property States **In scope for:** • Taxpayers who are not certain they are in a common law marriage (rules are complex and differ from state to state) • Applicable returns as limited by Site or Program Coordinator • Depending on your tax assistance program, community property tax laws for married taxpayers who file a separate return from their spouse	
F 8959		No	Additional Medicare Tax	
F 8960		No	Net Investment Income Tax – Individuals, Estates and Trusts	
F 8962		Yes	Premium Tax Credit (PTC) **Not in scope for:** • Self-employed health coverage deductions for taxpayers who are also allowed a PTC • Form 8962 Part IV, Allocation of Policy Amounts, and Part V, Alternative Calculation for Year of Marriage • Individuals eligible for the health coverage tax credit • If there is a code FF on Form W-2, box 12 and the employee has a Marketplace policy and is otherwise eligible for PTC	Advanced certification required
F 8995		Yes	Qualified Business Income Deduction Simplified Computation **Not in scope for:** • Certain rental real estate enterprises treated as a single trade or business	Advanced Certification required
F 8995-A		No	Qualified Business Income Deduction	
F 9452		No	Filing Assistance Program	
F 9465		Yes	Installment Agreement Request (See fee schedule)	
F 13844		No	Application For Reduced User Fee For Installment Agreement	
F 14039		Yes	Identity Theft Affidavit	
F SS-8		No	Determination of Worker Status for Purposes of Federal Employment Taxes and Income Tax Withholding	
FinCEN F 114		No	Report of Foreign Bank and Financial Accounts	

VITA/TCE Quality Site Requirements

All taxpayers using the services offered through the Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) and Tax Counseling for the Elderly (TCE) Programs should be confident they are receiving accurate tax return preparation and quality service. The purpose of the ten **Quality Site Requirements (QSRs)** is to ensure quality and accurate tax return preparation and consistent site operations. The QSRs are required to be communicated to all volunteers and partners to ensure IRS and partner mutual objectives are met. The 10 requirements are listed below.

1. Certification
2. Intake/Interview & Quality Review Process
3. Photo ID and Taxpayer ID Numbers
4. Reference Materials
5. Volunteer Agreement
6. Timely Filing
7. Civil Rights
8. Site Identification Number (SIDN)
9. Electronic Filing Identification Number (EFIN)
10. Security

For additional information refer to Publication 5166,VITA/TCE Quality Site Requirements.



These provisions, which previously expired at the end of 2017, have been renewed through tax year 2020. Refer to this tab and the Legislative Extenders lesson in Publication 4491 for information about these provisions.

Discharge of Qualified Principal Residence Indebtedness

Use the job aid on the following page to determine if the debt forgiveness on the main home is within scope.

Taxpayers may exclude from income certain debt forgiven or canceled debt on their principal residence. This exclusion is applicable to the discharge of "qualified principal residence indebtedness." If the canceled debt qualifies for exclusion from gross income, the debtor may be required to reduce tax attributes (certain credits, losses, and basis of assets) by the amount excluded.

If a property was taken by the lender (foreclosure) or given up by the borrower (abandonment), the lender usually sends the taxpayer Form 1099-A, Acquisition or Abandonment of Secured Property. Form 1099-A will have information needed to determine the gain or loss due to the foreclosure or abandonment.

If the debt is canceled, the taxpayer will receive Form 1099-C, Cancellation of Debt. If foreclosure/abandonment and debt cancellation occur in the same calendar year, the lender may issue only Form 1099-C, including the information that would be reported on Form 1099-A.

Volunteers may assist taxpayers who meet the following requirements:

- The home was never used in a business or as rental property
- The debt was not canceled because the taxpayer filed bankruptcy
- The taxpayer isn't in bankruptcy when he/she comes to the site for assistance
- Form 1099-C doesn't include an amount for interest
- The debt must be a mortgage used only to buy, build, or substantially improve the taxpayer's primary residence, i.e., this money was not used to pay off credit cards, medical/dental expenses, vacations, etc.
- The mortgage was secured by the taxpayer's primary residence
- The mortgage was not more than $2 million ($1 million if Married Filing Separately)

 **TaxSlayer Hint:** To exclude debt forgiven on principal residence, go to Other Income, Cancellation of Debt then Exclusions (Form 982).

Note 1: Form 1099-C, Box 3 (Interest if included in Box 2, Amount of Debt Canceled) and Box 16 Out of Scope.

Note 2: If a bankruptcy, Out of Scope.

Note 3: If personally liable for the debt, sales price is the lesser of balance of principal outstanding (Form 1099-A, box 2) or fair market value of property (Form 1099-A, box 4); if not personally liable on the debt, sales price is the balance or principal outstanding.

Publication 4731-A

Screening Sheet for Foreclosures/Abandonments and Cancellation of Debt

If the taxpayer is in bankruptcy, the tax return is Out of Scope for the VITA/TCE Programs.

Instructions: Use this Screening Sheet to assist taxpayers with Form(s) 1099-A and/or 1099-C with cancellation of debt issues.

- Use Part I for taxpayers with only Form 1099-A for a foreclosure or abandonment of their principal residence.
- Use Part II for taxpayers with Form 1099-C, or both Forms 1099-A and 1099-C resulting from cancellation of debt on a home mortgage loan.
- Use Publication 4731, Screening Sheet for Nonbusiness Credit Card Debt Cancellation, for taxpayers with Form 1099-C resulting from cancellation of credit card debt.

Part I – Home Mortgage Loan

STEP 1	Did the taxpayer receive Form 1099-A, Acquisition or Abandonment of Secured Property, from their home mortgage lender?	**YES** – Go to Step 2 **NO** – Advise the taxpayer to get the documentation from the home mortgage lender.
STEP 2	Did the taxpayer ever use the home in a trade or business or as rental property?	**YES** – Go to Step 6 **NO** – Go to Step 3
STEP 3	Is box 5 of Form 1099-A checked indicating a recourse loan in which the taxpayer is personally liable?	**YES** – The sales price is the lesser of box 2 (Balance of principal outstanding) or box 4 (Fair Market Value of Property) on Form 1099-A. **NO** – The sales price is the amount in box 2 (Balance of principal outstanding) on Form 1099-A. The taxpayer is not personally liable (nonrecourse loan).

STEP 4 Ask the taxpayer for the cost or basis of the home.

Refer to Publication 523, Selling your Home, for further information, if needed.

STEP 5 Report the sale of the personal residence on Form 8949, Sales and Other Disposition of Capital Assets, and Schedule D, Capital Gains and Losses.

If the disposition of the property results in a:

Gain – The taxpayer may qualify for the Section 121 exclusion ($250,000 or $500,000 if Married Filing Jointly) of the gain on the sale of a principal residence, if all requirements are met.

Loss – The taxpayer cannot claim a loss on the sale or disposition of a principal residence. Use adjustment Code L on Form 8949 to exclude this loss.

Refer to Publication 4012 (Legislative Extenders Tab), “Entering Forgiveness of Qualified Principal Residence Indebtedness” for further information.

STEP 6 These tax issues are outside the scope of the volunteer program.

Refer the taxpayer to:

- IRS website for the most up-to-date information.
- The Taxpayer Advocate Service (TAS): 1-877-777-4778, TTY/TDD 1-800-829-4059. TAS may help if the problem cannot be resolved through normal IRS channels.
- A professional tax preparer.

Additional Resources:

- Publication 523, Selling your Home
- Publication 525, Taxable and Nontaxable Income
- Publication 4681, Canceled Debts, Foreclosures, Repossessions, and Abandonments

Entering Forgiveness of Qualified Principal Residence Indebtedness (continued)



If the taxpayer had a portion of the mortgage debt canceled but kept the home (loan modification or mortgage workout):

- Enter the amount of debt canceled in Part II, Reduction of Tax Attributes, on the line for "Basis of your principal residence" (line 10b).

Foreclosure and Abandonment Key Highlights

If the taxpayer disposed of the home due to foreclosure or abandonment, and the lender canceled the remaining mortgage debt:

- No entry is made in Part II, Reduction of Tax Attributes
- Report the gain or loss from Form 1099-A in the Schedule D, Capital Gains section
  - The basis is the taxpayer's adjusted basis in the home
  - The sale price (amount realized) is based on whether the taxpayer is personally liable (recourse loan) or not personally liable (nonrecourse loan) for the debt:
    - If the taxpayer is personally liable, the sale price is the lesser of the balance of the principal mortgage debt outstanding or the fair market value
    - If the taxpayer isn't personally liable, then the sale price is the full amount of the outstanding debt, as reflected on Form 1099-A
    - For both recourse and nonrecourse loans, add any proceeds the taxpayer received from the foreclosure sale to the amount realized.
  - If the taxpayer ends up with a gain on the sale, some or all of the gain can be excluded under the rules for sale of main home, if the taxpayer qualifies
    - A loss on the main home **can't** be deducted

Tuition and Fees Deduction at a Glance

Don't rely on this table alone. Refer to Publication 17 complete details.

Question	Answer
What is the maximum benefit?	You can reduce your income subject to tax by up to $4,000.
Limit on modified adjusted gross income (MAGI)	$160,000 if married filing joint return; $80,000 if single, head of household, or qualifying widow(er). MFS is not eligible.
Where is the deduction taken?	As an adjustment to income on Schedule 1.
For whom must the expenses be paid?	A student enrolled in an eligible educational institution who is either: • you • your spouse, or • your dependent for whom you claim an exemption
What tuition and fees are deductible?	Tuition and fees required for enrollment or attendance at an eligible postsecondary educational institution, but not including personal, living or family expenses, such as room and board.
What records does the taxpayer need?	Beginning in tax year 2016, the tuition and fees deduction won't be allowed unless the taxpayer possesses a valid information return (Form 1098-T, Tuition Statement) from the educational institution.

Residential Energy Credits

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Deductions>Credits>Residential Energy Credit; or Keyword “5695”

Part I of Form 5695, Residential Energy Efficient Property Credit, is available for taxpayers who purchased qualified residential alternative energy equipment, such as solar hot water heaters, geothermal heat pumps and wind turbines. This part of the form is Out of Scope. Taxpayers that have these expenses should be referred to a professional tax preparer.

Part II, Form 5695 - Key points about the Nonbusiness Energy Property Credit:

- A total combined credit limit of $500 ($200 limit for windows) for all tax years after 2005.
- The maximum credit for residential energy property costs is $50 for any advanced main air circulating fan; $150 for any qualified natural gas, propane, or oil furnace, or hot water boiler; and $300 for any item of energy-efficient building property. Any of the following that meet the required efficiency rating may qualify as energy-efficient building property. See the Instructions for Form 5695 for details:
  - Electric heat pump water heater; electric heat pump; central air conditioner; natural gas, propane, or oil water heater; a stove that uses the burning of biomass fuel to heat your home or heat water for your home.
- The credit applies to:
  - Qualified energy efficiency improvements such as adding insulation, energy-efficient exterior windows and doors, and qualifying metal or asphalt roofs. (doesn’t include labor costs for onsite preparation, assembly or installation)
  - Qualified residential energy property improvements such as energy-efficient heating and air conditioning systems. For a complete list of items see Form 5695. (includes labor costs for onsite preparation, assembly, or original installation)
- The improvements must be made to the taxpayer’s main home located in the United States (must be existing home).
- Qualifying improvements must be placed into service by the taxpayer during the tax year.
- Expenditures which are made from subsidized energy financing can’t be used to figure the credit.
- The credit is taken on Part II, Form 5695. See Form 5695 and Instructions for more information.

Note: Not all ENERGY STAR products qualify for a tax credit. Since 2016, exterior doors, exterior windows, and skylights are only eligible for the nonbusiness energy property credit if they meet or exceed the specific requirements of the version 6.0 Energy Star program. For detailed information about qualifying improvements, visit the U.S. Department of Energy’s EnergyStar website.

Manufacturers must certify that their products meet new standards and they must provide a written statement to the taxpayer such as with the product packaging or in a printable format on the manufacturer’s website. Taxpayers should keep a copy of the manufacturer’s certification statement and receipts with their other important tax records.

Notes

Income Quick Reference Guide

This list is a quick reference and volunteers should refer to Publication 17 for more information. Don't rely on this list alone. **Some of the income items on this chart are Out of Scope for VITA/TCE.** Review the Scope of Service chart to identify Out of Scope items. Refer taxpayers with Out of Scope income to a professional tax preparer. Confirm that all income received by the taxpayer has been discussed and shown on the return, if required.

Table A – Examples of Taxable Income

(Examples of income to consider when determining whether a return must be filed or if a person meets the gross income test for qualifying relative)

- Wages, salaries, bonuses, commissions
- Alimony (for divorce before 2019, see How/Where to Enter Income, later)
- Annuities
- Awards
- Back pay
- Breach of contract payment
- Business income/Self-employment income
- Cash income
- Compensation for personal services
- Canceled debts[1]
- Director's fees
- Disability benefits (employer-funded)
- Discounts
- Dividends
- Employee awards
- Employee bonuses
- Estate and trust income
- Farm income
- Fees
- Gains from sale of property or securities
- Gambling winnings
- Hobby income
- Interest
- Interest on life insurance dividends
- IRA distributions
- Jury duty fees
- Military pay (not exempt from taxation)
- Military pension
- Nonemployee compensation
- Notary fees
- Partnership, Estate and S-Corporation income (Schedule K-1s, Taxpayer's share)
- Pensions
- Prizes
- Punitive damage award
- Railroad retirement—Tier I (portion may be taxable)
- Railroad retirement—Tier II
- Recovery of prior year deduction[2] (medical, property taxes, etc.)
- Refunds of State and local income tax (if reportable)[2]
- Rents (gross rent)
- Rewards
- Royalties
- Severance pay
- Self-employment (gross income)
- Social security benefits - portion may be taxable - (See Tab D, Income, Railroad Retirement, Civil Service, and Social Security Benefits)
- Supplemental unemployment benefits
- Taxable scholarships and grants
- Tips and gratuities
- Tribal per capita payments
- Unemployment compensation

Table B – Examples of Nontaxable Income

(Examples of income items to exclude when determining whether a return must be filed)

- Aid to Families with Dependent Children (AFDC)
- Child support
- Civil damages, restitution or other monetary award paid to someone because that person was wrongfully incarcerated
- Damages for physical injury (other than punitive)
- Death payments
- Dividends on life insurance
- Federal Employees' Compensation Act payments
- Federal income tax refunds
- Gifts
- Inheritance[3] or bequest
- Insurance proceeds (Accident, Casualty, Health, Life)
- Interest on tax-free securities
- Interest on EE/I bonds redeemed for qualified higher education expenses
- Meals and lodging for the convenience of employer
- Olympic and Paralympic Games medals and prizes[4]
- Payments to the beneficiary of a deceased employee
- Payments in lieu of worker's compensation
- Relocation payments
- Rebate/Patronage Dividends issued by co-ops for personal use are not taxable.
- Rental less than 15 days[5]
- Rental allowance of clergyman
- Reverse mortgages
- Sickness and injury payments
- Social security benefits - portion may not be taxable (See Tab D, Income, Railroad Retirement, Civil Service, and Social Security Benefits)
- Supplemental Security Income (SSI)
- Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF)
- Veterans' benefits
- Welfare payments (including TANF) and food stamps
- Worker's compensation and similar payments

Footnotes

[1] If the taxpayer received a Form 1099-C, Cancellation of Debt, in relation to their main home, it can be nontaxable

[2] If itemized in year paid and taxes were reduced because of deduction

[3] An inheritance isn't reported on the income tax return, but a distribution from an inherited pension or annuity is subject to the same tax as the original owner would have had to pay.

[4] The exclusion does not apply to a taxpayer for any year in which the taxpayer's AGI exceeds $1 million (or $500,000 for an individual filing a MFS return).

[5] If you use a dwelling unit as a home and you rent it less than 15 days during the year, you are not required to report the rental income and rental expenses from this activity. See Publication 527, Residential Rental Property. (Military Certification only)

Armed Forces Gross Income

Members of the Armed Forces receive many different types of pay and allowances. Some are included in gross income while others are excluded from gross income. **Table 1** lists included items that are subject to tax and must be reported on your tax return. **Table 2** lists excluded items that are not subject to tax, but may have to be shown on your tax return. See Publication 3, Armed Forces' Tax Guide, for additional information.

Table 1—Included Items

These items are included in gross income, unless the pay is for service in a combat zone

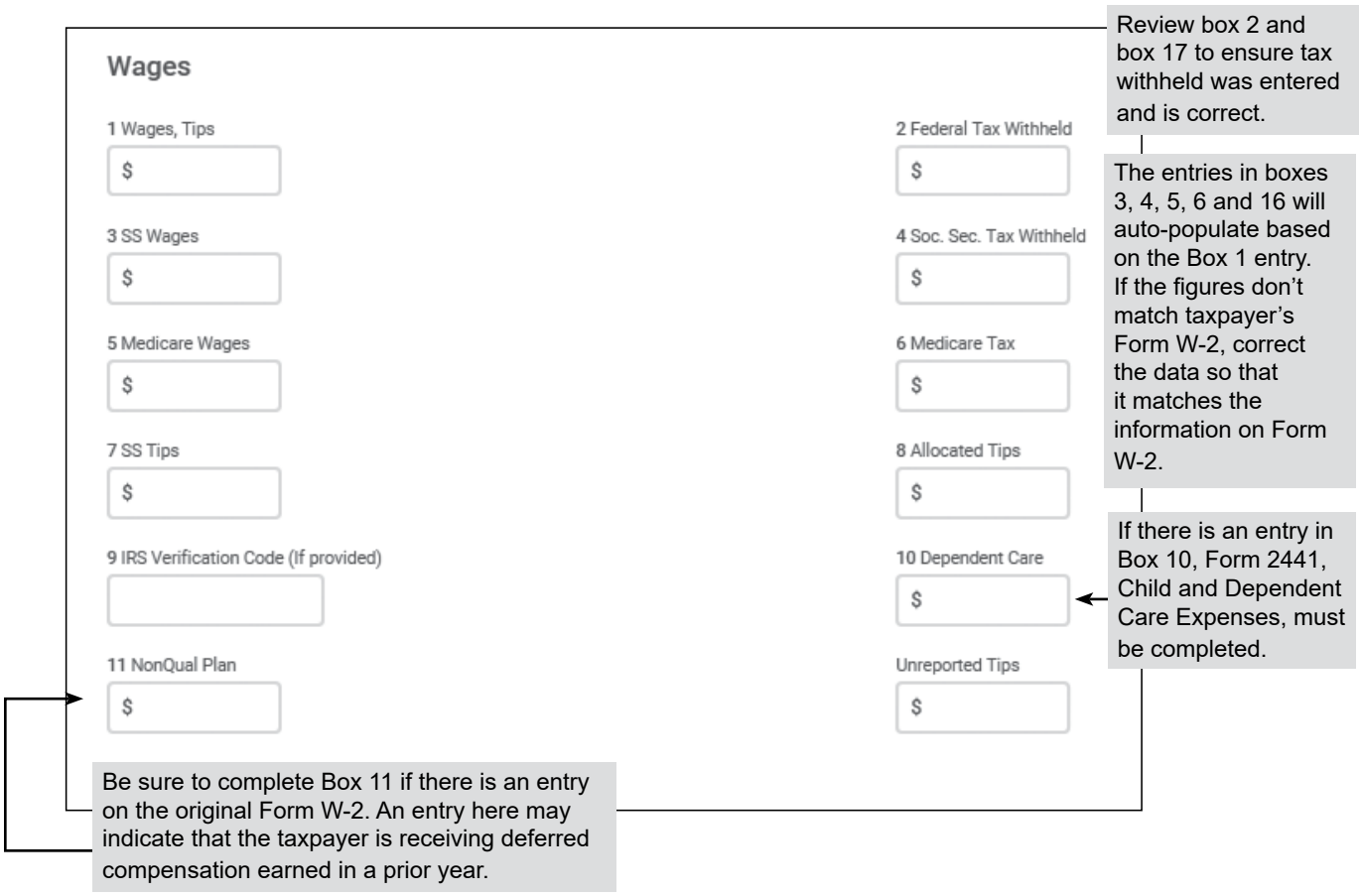
Basic pay	• Active duty • Attendance at a designated service school • Back wages • Drills (Inactive Duty Training) • Reserve training • Training Duty	**Special pay (cont.)**	• Hostile fire or imminent danger • Medical and dental officers • Nuclear-qualified officers • Optometry • Other Health Professional Special Pay (for example, nurse, physician assistant, social work, etc.) • Pharmacy • Special compensation for assistance with activities of daily living (SCAADL) • Special duty assignment pay • Veterinarian • Voluntary Separation Incentive	**Incentive pay**	• Submarine • Flight • Hazardous duty • High altitude/Low altitude (HALO)
				Other pay	• Accrued leave • CONUS COLA • High deployment per diem • Personal money allowances paid to high ranking officers • Student loan repayment from programs such as the Department of Defense Educational Loan Repayment Program when year's service (requirement) isn't attributable to a combat zone
Special pay	• Aviation career incentives • Career sea • Diving duty • Foreign duty (outside the 48 contiguous states and the District of Columbia) • Foreign language proficiency • Hardship duty	**Bonus pay**	• Career status • Continuation pay • Enlistment • Officer • Overseas extension • Reenlistment	**In-kind military benefits**	• Personal use of government-provided vehicle

Table 2—Excluded Items

The exclusion for certain items applies whether the item is furnished in-kind or is a reimbursement or allowance. There is no exclusion for the personal use of a government-provided vehicle.

Combat zone and qualified hazardous duty area pay	• Compensation for active service while in a combat zone **Note:** Limited amount for commissioned officers • Leave earned or accrued while performing service in a combat zone	**Family allowances**	• Certain educational expenses for dependents • Emergencies • Evacuation to a place of safety • Separation	**Travel allowances**	• Annual round trip for dependent students • Leave between consecutive overseas tours • Reassignment in a dependent restricted status • Transportation for you or your dependents during ship overhaul or inactivation • Per diem
Other pay	• Certain amounts received under Armed Force Health Professions Scholarship and Financial Assistance Program payments • Disability, including payments received for injuries incurred as a direct result of a terrorist or military action • Disability severance payments • Group-term life insurance • Professional education • ROTC educational and subsistence allowances • State bonus pay for service in a combat zone • Survivor and retirement protection plan premiums • Uniform allowances • Uniforms furnished to enlisted personnel	**Living allowances**	• BAH (Basic Allowance for Housing) • BAS (Basic Allowance for Subsistence) • Housing and cost-of-living allowances abroad paid by the U.S. Government or by a foreign government • OHA (Overseas Housing Allowance)	**In-kind military benefits**	• Dependent-care assistance program • Defense Counsel Services • Legal assistance • Medical/dental care • Commissary/exchange discounts • Space-available travel on government aircraft • Uniforms furnished to enlisted personnel
Death allowances	• Burial services • Death gratuity payments to eligible survivors • Travel of dependents to burial site	**Moving allowances**	• Dislocation • Military base realignment and closure benefit (the exclusion is limited as described above) • Move-in housing • Move household and personal items • Moving trailers or mobile homes • Storage • Temporary lodging and temporary lodging expenses		

Form W-2 Instructions (continued)



CAUTION IRS requires that information on electronically filed Form(s) W-2 match the printed Form(s) W-2 exactly if possible. For example, the name cannot be changed, and the software will not accept special characters.

TIP If the taxpayer earned tips that weren't reported to the employer, enter in the Unreported Tips box. This will add Form 4137, Social Security and Medicare Tax on Unreported Tip Income, to the return. If the taxpayer received tips that weren't reported to the employer because they were less than $20 a month, go to other taxes, select Form 4137 and also enter the amount there. If a taxpayer wishes to use their tip log instead of allocated tips in box 8, leave box 8 blank and report it as unreported tips within the W-2.

Form W-2 Instructions (continued)

For Box 12 and 14, choose the code from the drop-down menu and enter the dollar amount. If there are more than 4 items in box 12, enter the items that impact the tax return (Code D, E, G, P, Q, T, W, AA, BB, EE).

Be sure to select the correct items for Box 13 as indicated on Forms W-2. This is important in calculating the deductibility of IRA contributions.

If statutory employee is marked, employment taxes are withheld by the employer, but the taxpayer will report income and deduct expenses using Schedule C. Re-enter income as statutory income on Schedule C Income screen. Also enter related expenses. Do not mix statutory employee income with other income on the same Schedule C.



Select from the drop-down list for box 14. If the amount is eligible for the retirement saver's contributions credit, select Retirement (Not in Box 12)- Carry to Form 8880.

If Box 16 and Box 17 are both blank, leave Box 15 blank.

Excludable Medicaid waiver payments are certain payments received for providing nonmedical support services under a plan of care to someone living in the taxpayer's home. For more information about these payments, see Publication 17 or Publication 525.

If the Form W-2 shows withholding from more than one state, select the **Add State** button to add the additional information.

Form W-2 Reference Guide for Common Box 12 Codes

A Uncollected social security or RRTA tax on tips
B Uncollected Medicare tax on tips
D Elective deferrals to a section 401(k) cash or deferred arrangement
E Elective deferrals under a section 403(b) salary reduction agreement
G Elective deferrals and employer contributions (including nonelective deferrals) to a section 457(b) deferred compensation plan
J Nontaxable sick pay
P Excludable moving expense reimbursements paid directly to employee
Q Nontaxable combat pay (Military certification)
R Employee Contributions to MSA, Out of Scope
T Adoption benefits (Out of Scope)
W Employer contributions (including amounts the employee contributes through a cafeteria plan) to employee's health savings account (HSA certification)
AA Designated Roth contributions under a section 401(k) plan
BB Designated Roth contributions under a section 403(b) plan
EE Designated Roth contributions under a governmental section 457(b) plan

Codes D, E, and G indicate elective (voluntary) contributions which qualify for Retirement Savings Credit.

Interest Income (continued)

Enter the amount of tax-exempt interest from Box 8 of Form 1099-INT.

The entry for “Specified Private Activity Bond” will automatically carry to Form 6251, Alternative Minimum Tax, when applicable. If the entry into Other Taxes on Form 6251 results in an alternative minimum tax (AMT), the return is out of scope.

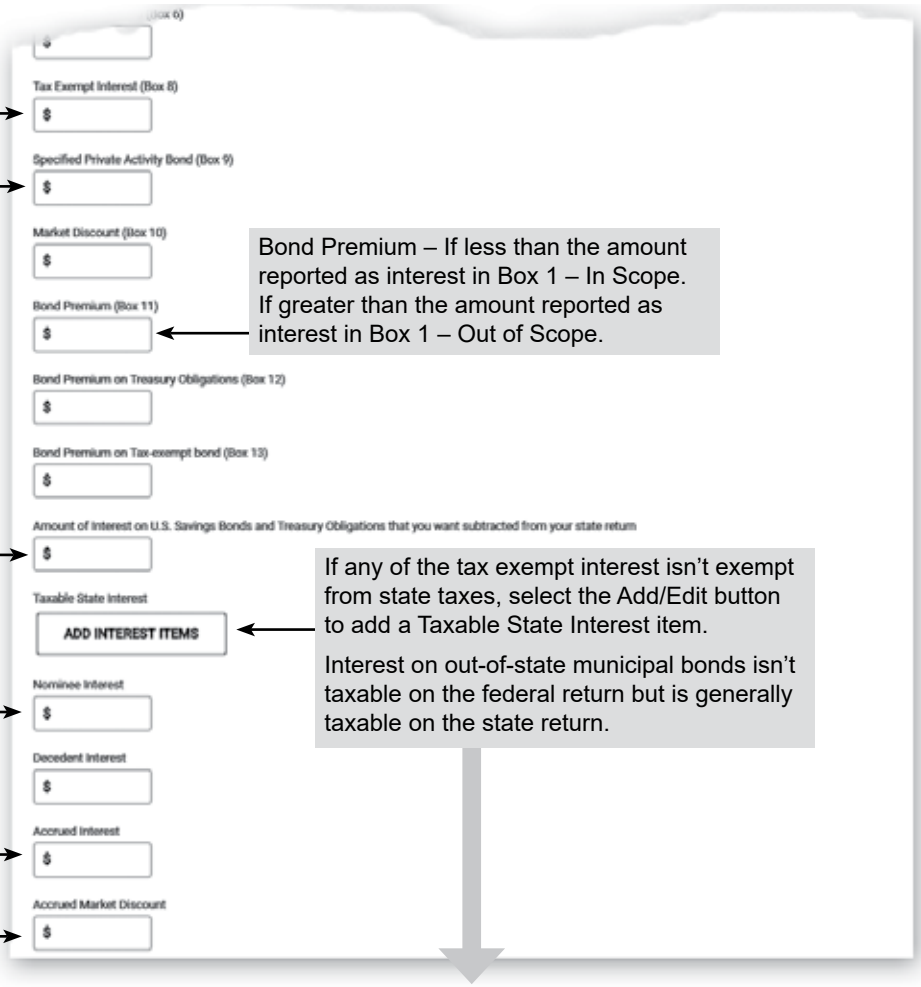
IMPORTANT – Entries are transferred directly when a state return is added. If state tax law treats the interest differently, include the exempt interest amount and select the state from the drop down list.

Generally, interest on U.S. government obligations (such as savings bonds, treasury bonds/bills/notes) is taxable on the federal return but isn’t taxable on the state return.

Nominee interest – Interest transferred to another person – Out of Scope.

Accrued interest – Interest paid to seller at time of purchase – Out of Scope.

Accrued Market Discount – gain in value of discount bond - Out of Scope



Bond Premium – If less than the amount reported as interest in Box 1 – In Scope. If greater than the amount reported as interest in Box 1 – Out of Scope.

If any of the tax exempt interest isn’t exempt from state taxes, select the Add/Edit button to add a Taxable State Interest item.

Interest on out-of-state municipal bonds isn’t taxable on the federal return but is generally taxable on the state return.

Enter the state and amount and select Continue To Next Step.



TIP Always enter tax-exempt interest or dividend income. This may affect the amount of Social Security income that is taxable.

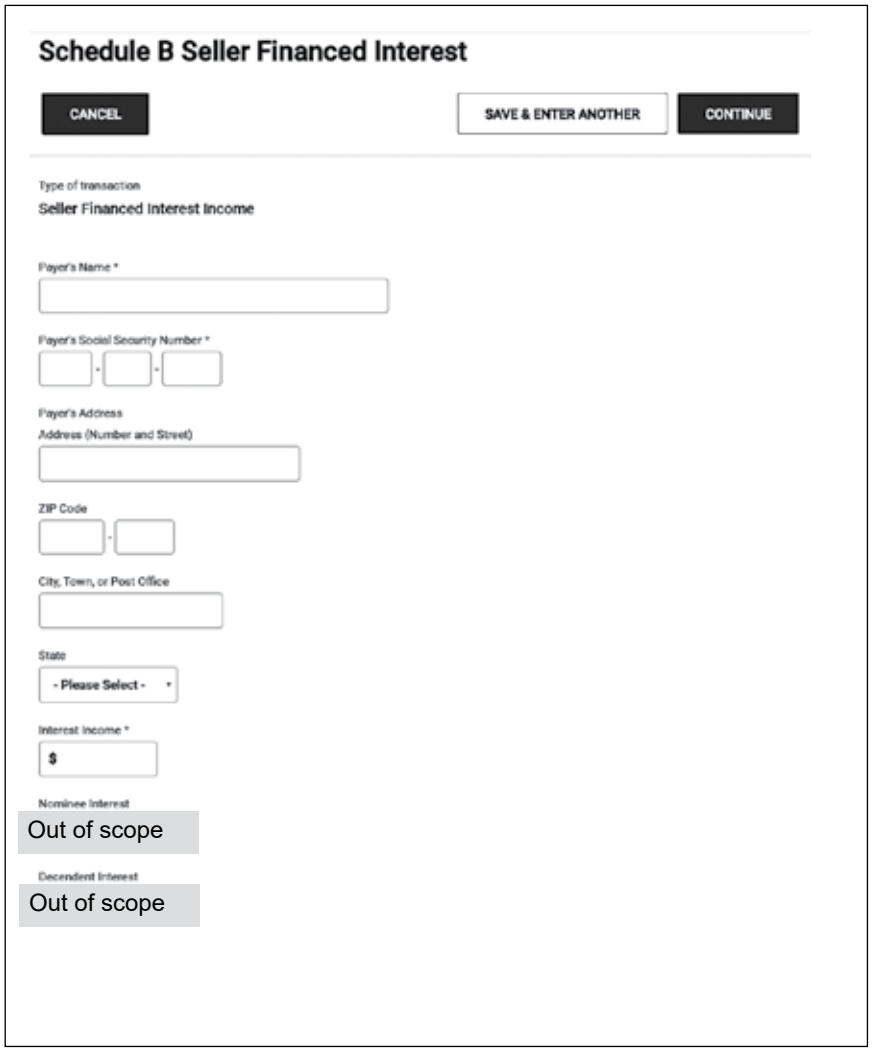
Note: Interest on in-state municipal bonds is generally not taxable on the federal and state returns.

Note: Income from a reverse mortgage is not considered a taxable event because it is a loan.

Seller Financed Mortgage Interest

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Income>Interest and Dividends>Seller Financed Interest Income; or Keyword “INT”

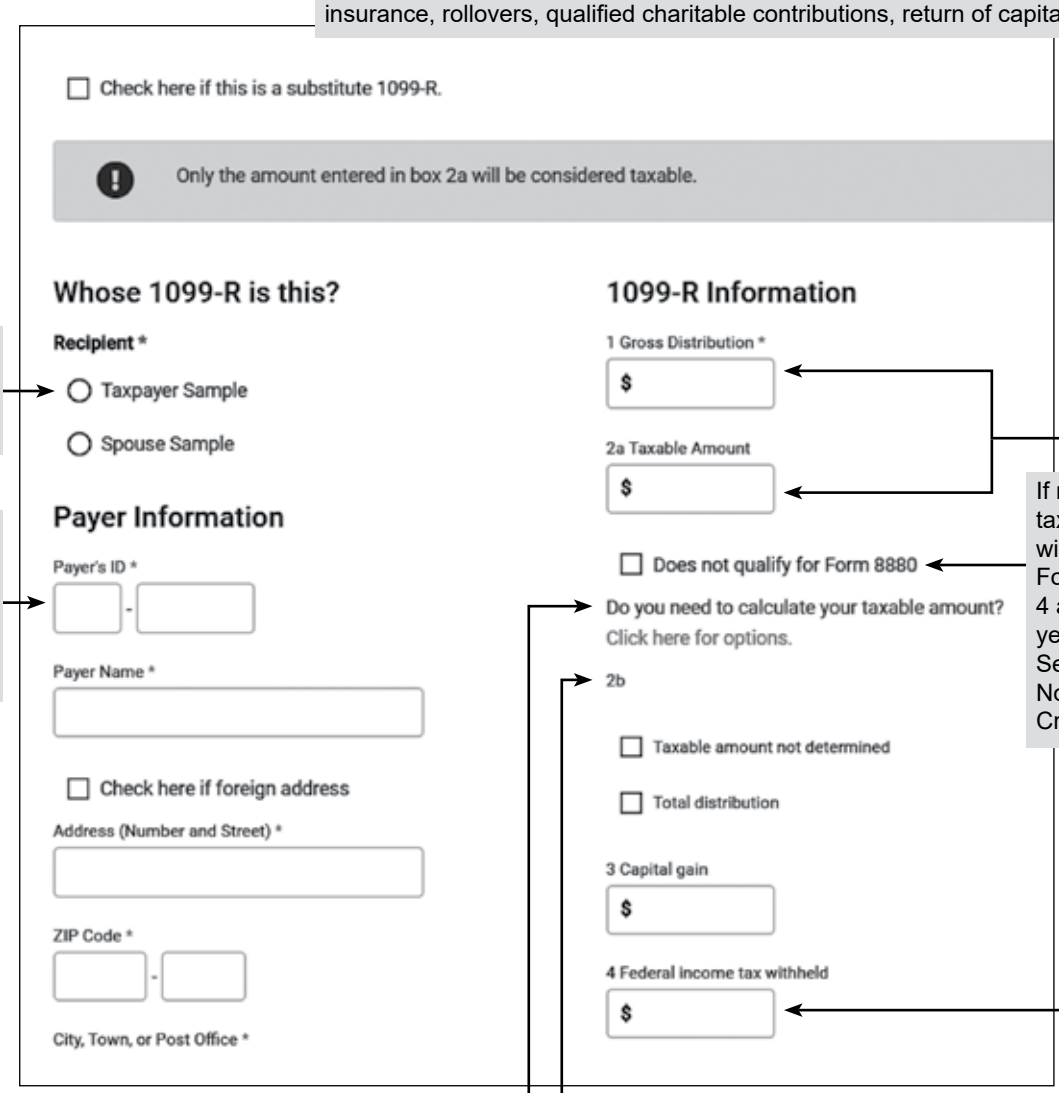
CAUTION Must have identification number of payer to e-file the return.



Form 1099-R

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Income>IRA/Pension Distributions>Add or Edit a 1099-R; or Keyword “R”

CAUTION Box 2a will automatically fill in with the amount in Box 1. If a different amount is shown on the document, enter that amount directly. If the taxable amount is not determined, Box 2b will be marked, and Box 2a may be blank, zero or the same as Box 1. In that case, you may need to use the Simplified Method. Make sure Box 2a reflects any changes due to Simplified Method, Public Safety Officer (PSO) health insurance, rollovers, qualified charitable contributions, return of capital, etc.



If a joint return, choose who the document belongs to.

EIN must be entered accurately. Incorrect EIN is a common e-file reject.

If marked, the taxable amount will not carry to Form 8880, Line 4 as a current year distribution. See Tab G, Nonrefundable Credits.

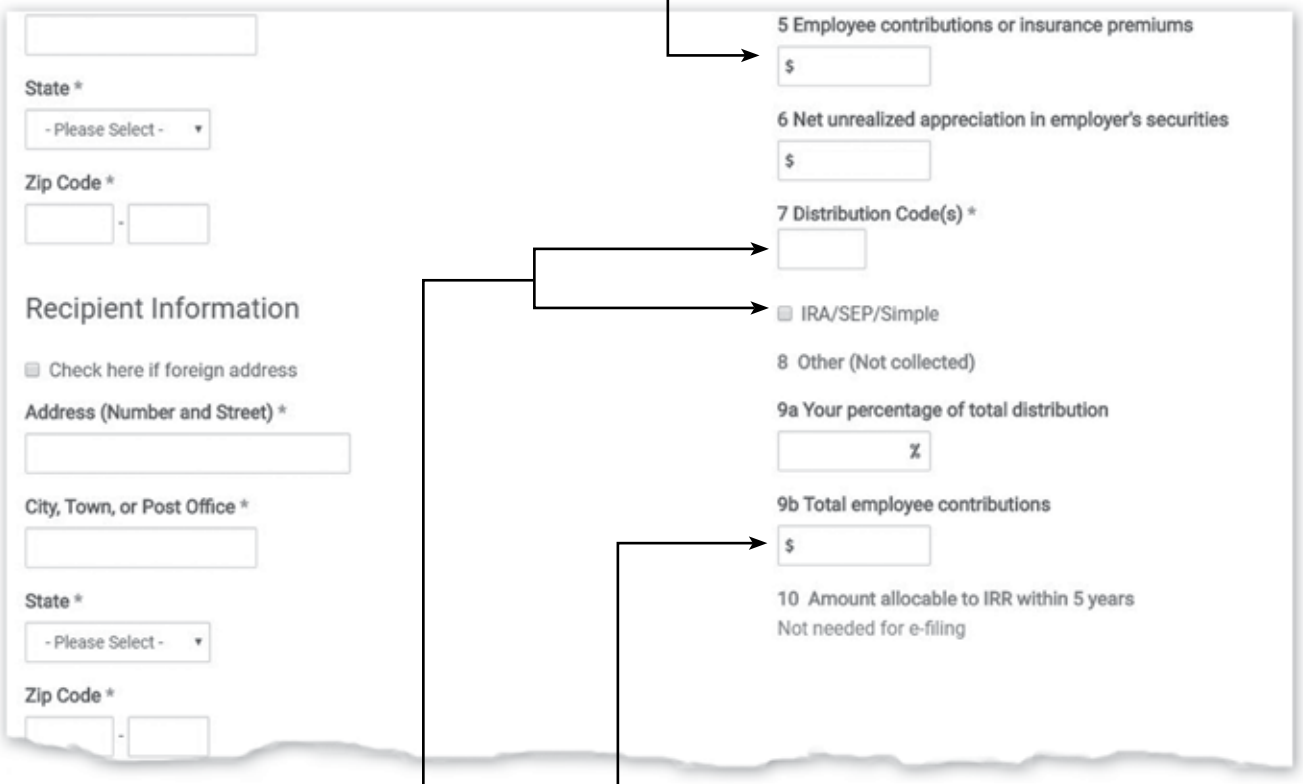
If Simplified Method is required or if the taxpayer has public safety officer health insurance deduction, click here for worksheet.

Box 2b indicates “Taxable amount not determined” and “Total distribution”. Mark exactly as shown on document.

If Box 4 has an entry, ensure that the tax withheld is entered and is correct.

Form 1099-R (continued)

Box 5 on the document may be current year's amount of employee contributions or insurance premiums (recovery of cost basis or investment in the contract). If Box 5 is the same as Box 1, none of the distribution is taxable. If the payer has calculated the taxable amount of the pension in Box 2, generally the difference between Boxes 1 and 2 will appear in Box 5. If Box 5 is the same as Box 1, none of the distribution is taxable. If the payer has calculated the taxable amount of the pension in Box 2, generally the difference between Boxes 1 and 2 will appear in Box 5. If Box 5 is the amount of health insurance premiums, (typically only on a CSA 1099-R) you must manually carry the amount to the Schedule A, Itemized Deductions, Medical or Dental Expenses.



Box 7 is a required entry – Enter exactly as shown on document. If IRA/SEP/Simple is marked, check to enter exactly as on document. See Distribution Codes Chart in this tab.

Box 9b shows the total employee contributions and may be needed if Box 2 has no entry – usually requires Simplified Method Worksheet (see Box 2a).

12/2019

Note: Tax Law for Disaster Victims

At certain times, 401(k) and similar employer-sponsored retirement plans can make loans and hardship distributions to an individual whose principal place of abode is located in a disaster area and who sustained an economic loss. Taxpayers impacted by federally declared disasters in 2018, 2019, or 60 days from the December 30, 2020 enactment date of Public Law 116-94 H.R. 1865, Further Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2020 are allowed to obtain tax-favored withdrawals from retirement plans, by providing an exception to the 10 percent early retirement plan withdrawal penalty for qualified disaster relief distributions, providing favorable repayment terms over 3 years, and allowing taxpayers the option of spreading out income inclusion resulting from such withdrawals over a 3-year period. Search the IRS website for "Tax Relief in Disaster Situations" for more information. Any options that require the completion of Forms 8915 and/or 8606 are out of scope.

Form 1099-R Box 7 Distribution Codes

Box 7 Distribution Codes	Explanations
1 — Early distribution, no known exception	• If this amount was rolled over within 60 days of the withdrawal and—if the distribution was from an IRA--no prior rollover was made in the same 12-month period. Check the box under Rollover or Disability on Form 1099-R, and enter the amount rolled over. Trustee to trustee transfer isn't considered a prior rollover. If more than one rollover from an IRA in the 12-month period, return is Out of Scope. • If this wasn't rolled over, a 10% additional tax will be applied unless the taxpayer qualifies for an exception. See Tab H, Other Taxes, Payments and ACA, for a list of exceptions. If the taxpayer qualifies for an exception, go to Form 5329, Additional Taxes on Qualified Plans and Other Tax-Favored Accounts, enter the amount that qualifies for an exception and select the reason for the exception from the dropdown list. • If the IRA/SEP/SIMPLE box **IS** checked, additional reporting may be required on Form 8606, and the return is Out of Scope.
2 — Early distribution, exception applies	Code 2 applies if the taxpayer is under 59 ½ but the payer knows that an exception to the additional tax applies. If the IRA/SEP/SIMPLE box **ISN'T** checked, no further action needed. If the IRA/SEP/SIMPLE box **IS** checked, additional reporting may be required on Form 8606, and the return is Out of Scope.
3 — Disability	Code 3 is for a disability pension. • If the taxpayer is under the minimum retirement age for the company he retired from, then check the box under Rollover or Disability that says, "Check here to report as wages on the Form 1040." This will reclassify the disability income as wages. It will also include the amount in earned income for calculation of the earned income credit, the dependent care credit and the additional child tax credit. • If the taxpayer has reached the minimum retirement age, no further action is needed.
4 — Death	Code 4 is for a survivor's benefit or an inherited IRA. If it's a pension, the original retiree has died, and the survivor is receiving his or her share of the pension. If the original pensioner was using the Simplified Method, continue to use it for the survivor. If it's an inherited IRA and the original owner had a basis, the survivor takes over that basis and the return is Out of Scope.
5 — Prohibited transaction	This code is Out of Scope.
6 — Tax-free Section 1035 exchange	This code is Out of Scope.
7 — Normal distribution	Code 7 is for normal distributions. It may occur in several different situations: • If the amounts in Box 1 and 2a are the same, and Box 2b isn't checked, the pension is fully taxable. • If the taxpayer makes a rollover from one IRA to another and holds the money less than 60 days, enter the amount rolled over into the Rollover or Disability field. • If the Box 2b is checked and there is an amount in Box 9b, complete the Simplified Method. Be sure to use the taxpayer's age at the time of retirement—not current age. • If there is an amount in Box 2 that is different than Box 1, no further action is needed. • If there is no amount (or zero) in Box 2a, check to see if there is an amount in Box 5. If this is the same amount as Box 1, the distribution is the taxpayer's own money coming back. None of the distribution will be taxed. • If any portion of this distribution was sent directly from the trustee to a charity, and the taxpayer is over 70 1/2 years old, enter the net taxable amount in box 2a (which may be zero). Hit Continue and at the IRA/Pensions Distributions page, select Nontaxable Distributions and check the box to mark that there is a Qualified Charitable Distribution (QCD). No charitable deduction may be taken for the donation. • If the IRA/SEP/SIMPLE box **IS** checked, additional reporting may be required on Form 8606. In that case, the return is Out of Scope.
8 — Excess contributions	This code is Out of Scope.
9 — Cost of current life insurance	This code is Out of Scope

Form 1099-R Box 7 Distribution Codes (continued)

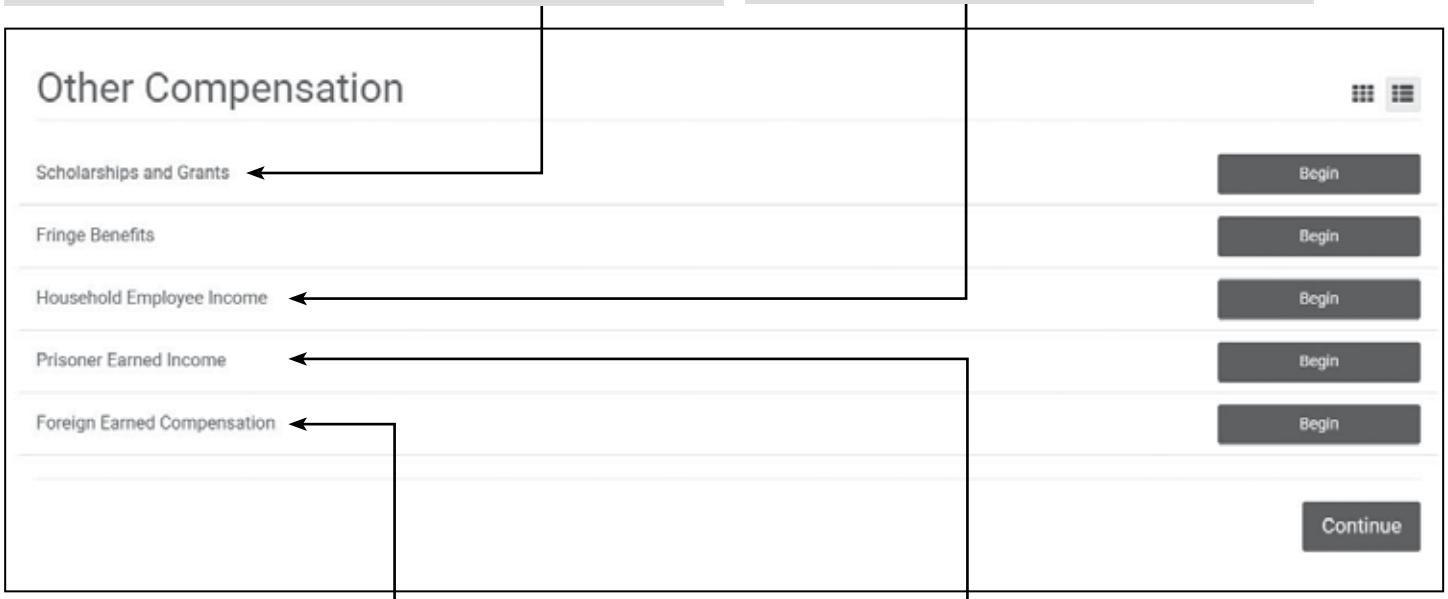
Box 7 Distribution Codes	Explanations
A — May be eligible for 10-year tax option	This code is Out of Scope.
B — Designated Roth account distribution	Code B is for a distribution from a designated Roth account. This code is in scope only if taxable amount has been determined.
D — Annuity payments from nonqualified annuities	Code D is used for a distribution from a private annuity in conjunction with the regular code. The distribution is subject to the net investment income tax. If the taxpayer has AGI over a threshold amount ($200,000 for a single taxpayer or HoH; $250,000 MFJ or QW; $125,000 MFS), then this code means the return is Out of Scope. If the AGI is less than the threshold amount the return is in scope and no further action is needed.
E — Distributions under Employee Plans Compliance Resolution System (EPCRS)	This code is Out of Scope.
F — Charitable gift annuity	Code F is used for the annuity payments from a charitable gift annuity. To determine the amount to enter in box 2a (taxable amount), subtract the amount in box 3 (cap gains) and box 5 (Employee Contribution) from the taxable amount (box 1). Enter the difference in Form 1099R screen box 2a. Also, navigate to Income>Capital Gains and Losses>Additional Capital Gain Distributions and enter the amount in box 3 as a long-term capital gain.
G — Direct rollover of distribution and direct payment	Code G is for a direct rollover from a qualified plan to an eligible retirement plan. If box 2a, taxable amount, is zero or blank, it won't be taxed. If there is an amount in box 2a, the direct rollover is fully or partially taxable. No further action is needed.
H — Direct rollover of a designated Roth account distribution to a Roth IRA	Code H is for a direct rollover of a distribution from a designated Roth account to a Roth IRA. It won't be taxed. No further action is needed. Box 2a should be blank. Place check mark in box IRA/SEP/SIMPLE.
J — Early distribution from a Roth IRA	This code is Out of Scope.
K — Distribution of Traditional IRA assets not having a readily available FMV	This code is Out of Scope.
L — Loans treated as deemed distributions	Code L is for loans treated as deemed distributions. This code could possibly be combined with codes 1, 4, or B. For more information on how it is treated see the codes on this chart.
N — Recharacterized IRA contribution	This code is Out of Scope.
P — Excess contributions plus earnings/excess deferrals	This code is Out of Scope.
Q — Qualified distribution from a Roth IRA	This distribution isn't taxable. TaxSlayer enters the distribution amount on Form 1040 on the IRAs, pensions, and annuities line. No further action is needed.
R — Recharacterized IRA contribution	This code is Out of Scope.
S — Early distribution from a SIMPLE IRA in the first 2 years, no known exception	A 25% additional tax will be applied unless the taxpayer qualifies for an exception. See Tab H for a list of exceptions. If the taxpayer qualifies for an exception, go to Form 5329 and enter the amount of the distribution not subject to the additional tax and the code for the exception and the amount that qualifies for it.
T — Roth IRA distribution, exception applies	This code is Out of Scope.
U — Dividends distributed from an ESOP	This code is Out of Scope.
W — Charges or payments for LTC contracts	This code is Out of Scope.

Entering Other Compensation in TaxSlayer

TaxSlayer Navigation: Income>Other Income>Other Income Not Reported Elsewhere

Scholarships and grants used to pay for tuition, fees and course-related expenses are not taxable. Use this link to report only amounts that were used for nonqualifying expenses. “SCH” will appear on the dotted line next to the wages line on Form 1040. Taxable scholarship is considered unearned income for most purposes but is considered earned income for determining filing requirement.

Enter wages received as a household employee for which the taxpayer did not receive a Form W-2 because the employer paid less than $2,100 in 2019. “HSH” will appear on the dotted line next to wages on Form 1040.



Enter foreign earned income (wages, salaries, etc.) paid by a foreign employer for work performed while the taxpayer lived in a foreign country.

Enter the amount received for work while an inmate in a penal institution. For purposes of the Earned Income Credit, this isn’t considered earned income. This includes amounts received for work performed while in a work release program or while in a halfway house. “PRI” will appear on the dotted line next to the line for wages on Form 1040. This entry is made in addition to entering the Form W-2 from the penal institution.

Entering Medicaid Waiver Payments

(that may be excluded from income under Notice 2014-7)

Scenario A:
If Medicaid waiver payments are reported on Form W-2, enter the amount reported in Box 1 and also enter the same amount reported in the unnumbered box labeled Medicaid waiver payments on the Form W-2 screen in TaxSlayer to exclude them.

Scenario B:
If income is reported on a Form 1099-MISC, and you are not in the business of providing home care services, go to Schedule 1 > Other income not reported elsewhere and enter Notice 2014-7 in the description field and $0 in the amount field.

Scenario C:
If income is reported on a Form 1099-MISC and you are in the business of providing home care services, enter the full amount of the payments under Gross Receipts in the Schedule C Income section. In Other Expenses, enter Notice 2014-7 as the description and the amount as a positive number.

Note: When the care provider and the care recipient do not live together in the same home, the Medicaid waiver payments are fully taxable.

Educator Expenses

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal section >Deductions >Adjustments>Educator Expenses

Don't rely on this table alone. Refer to Publication 17, Your Federal Income Tax For Individuals, for more details.

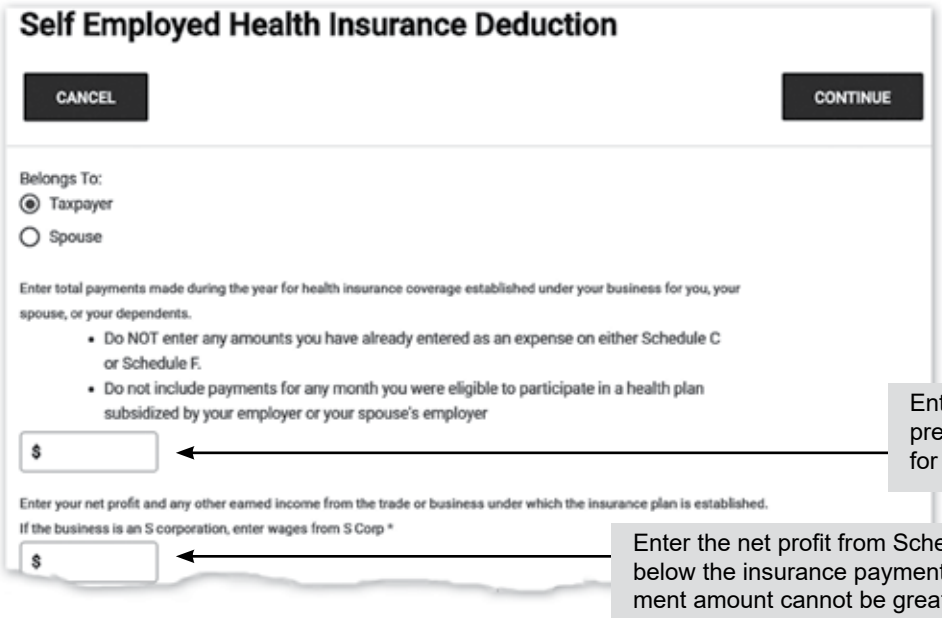
Question	Answer
What is the maximum benefit?	$250 (If the taxpayer and spouse are both eligible educators, they can deduct up to $500, but **neither** can deduct more than their own expenses up to $250).
Who can claim the expense?	Eligible Educators — an eligible educator is a kindergarten through grade 12 teacher, instructor, counselor, principal, or aide who worked in a school for at least 900 hours during a school year.
What are qualifying expenses?	Qualifying expenses include ordinary and necessary expenses paid in connection with books, supplies, equipment (including computer equipment, software, and services), and other materials used in the classroom. Additionally, professional development expenses are allowed.
What are nonqualifying expenses?	Expenses for home schooling or nonathletic supplies for courses in health or physical education.
What other issues apply?	Taxpayer must reduce qualified expenses by • Excludable U.S series EE and I savings bond interest from Form 8815 • Nontaxable qualified tuition program earnings or distributions • Nontaxable distribution of earnings from a Coverdell education savings account • Any reimbursements received for expenses that weren't reported on the Form W-2

Note: Professional development expenses include courses related to the curriculum in which the educator provides instruction.

CAUTION The deduction amount will be indexed for inflation for future years.

Self-Employed Health Insurance Deduction

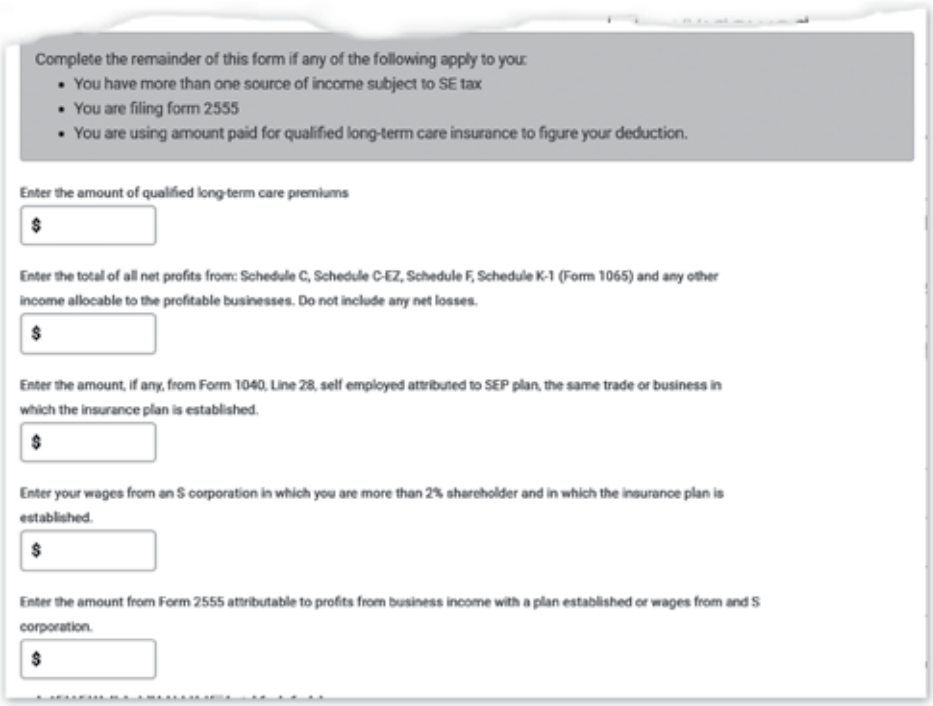
TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Adjustments>Self-Employment Health Insurance



Enter total amount of premiums paid here for health insurance

Enter the net profit from Schedule C in the field below the insurance payment amounts (the adjustment amount cannot be greater than the net profit from the business). TaxSlayer will automatically subtract the adjustment for ½ of SE tax.

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Adjustments>Self-Employment Health Insurance



Note: Calculations with Premium Tax Credit remain Out of Scope with respect to the self-employed health insurance deduction.

Interview Tips – Itemized Deductions

These interview tips will assist you in determining whether a taxpayer's itemized deductions are more than their standard deduction amount. It may be more advantageous for a taxpayer to itemize their deductions if the amount is larger than the allowable standard deduction amount.

step 1	Do you have expenses in the following categories: medical and dental expenses, taxes you paid, home mortgage interest you paid, gifts to charity, gambling losses and expenses incurred in gambling activities (to the extent of gambling winnings) and work related expenses for disabled individuals that enables them to work. **Note:** Casualty and theft losses are beyond the scope of VITA/TCE.	If **YES**, go to Step 2. If **NO**, generally speaking, you should take the standard deduction if eligible. For further explanation see exceptions in Publication 17, Your Federal Income Tax For Individuals, Standard Deduction chapter.
step 2	Were the medical and dental expenses paid by an employer under a pre-tax plan (not included in box 1 of the taxpayer's Form W-2) or were the expenses reimbursed by an insurance company?	If **YES**, you can't deduct reimbursed expenses. Go to Step 4. If **NO**, you can claim these expenses. Go to Step 3.
step 3	Were the medical and dental expenses more than 7.5% of your adjusted gross income? **Note:** You can include medical and dental bills you paid for: • Yourself and your spouse • All dependents you claim on your return • Your child whom you don't claim as a dependent because of the rules for children of divorced or separated parents • Any person you could have claimed as a dependent on your return except that person received $4,200 or more of gross income or filed a joint return • Any person you could have claimed as a dependent except that you, or your spouse if filing jointly, can be claimed as a dependent on someone else's 2019 return	If **YES**, you can claim qualified expenses. Go to Step 4. If **NO**, you can't deduct these expenses. Go to Step 4.
step 4	Were the following taxes you paid imposed on you: state and local general sales tax, state or local income tax, real or personal property taxes? **Note:** The total amount of these taxes is limited to $10,000 ($5,000 MFS) per return.	If **YES**, go to Step 5. If **NO**, you can't claim this expense as a deduction because you weren't obligated to pay the taxes. Go to Step 6.
step 5	Did you pay these taxes during this tax year?	If **YES**, you can claim these expenses and go to Step 6. If **NO**, you can't deduct taxes for this year that were paid in another year. Go to Step 6.
step 6	Are you legally liable for a home mortgage loan?	If **YES**, go to Step 7. If **NO**, you can't take an interest expense for a mortgage for which you aren't legally liable. Go to Step 13.

Interview Tips – Itemized Deductions (continued)

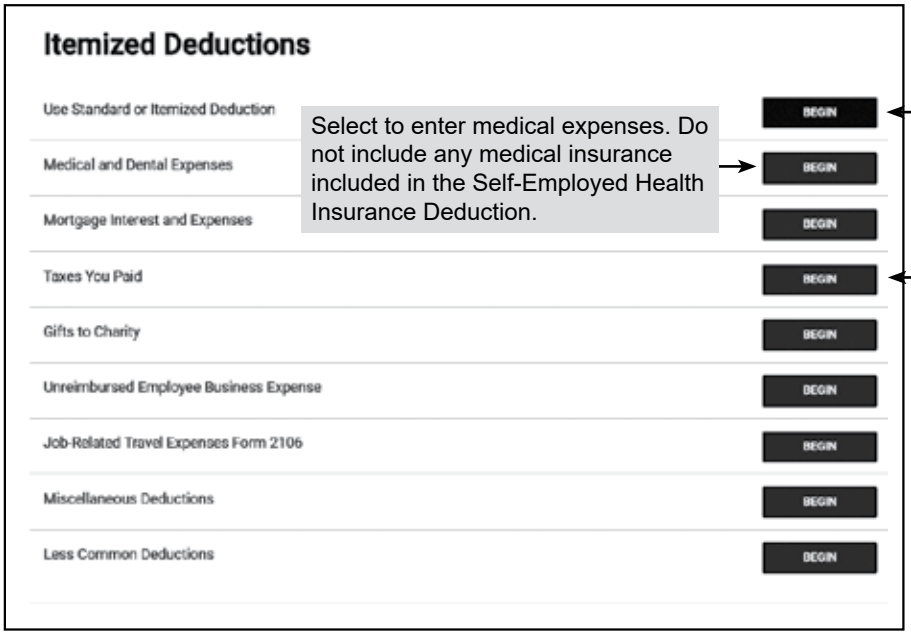
step 7	Was the mortgage a secured debt on a main or second home?	If **YES**, go to Step 8. If **NO**, you can't take an interest expense. Go to Step 12.
step 8	Did you pay the mortgage interest in this tax year?	If **YES**, go to Step 9. If **NO**, you can't take the mortgage interest deduction. Go to Step 12.
step 9	Did you take out the mortgage on or before October 13, 1987?	If **YES**, your mortgage interest is fully deductible. Go to Step 10. If **NO**, follow the flowchart, "Is My Home Mortgage Interest Fully Deductible" in Publication 17 to determine what is deductible. Go to Step 12.
step 10	Did you pay premiums in 2019 for qualified mortgage insurance for a home acquisition debt that was issued afer 2006?	If **YES**, you can take a deduction for qualified mortgage insurance as home mortgage interest with AGI limitations. If **NO**, you can't take a deduction for qualified mortgage insurance as home mortgage interest. Go to Step 11.
step 11	Did you pay points to obtain a home mortgage (on a main home or second home or home improvement loan or to refinance your home)?	If **YES**, follow the "Are My Points Fully Deductible This Year" flowchart in Publication 17 and then go to Step 12. See **Note 1**. If **NO**, go to Step 12.
step 12	Did you have home equity interest that was used to buy, build, or improve your home?	If **YES**, your home equity interest is deductible. If **NO**, go to Step 13.
step 13	Did you make a cash contribution to a qualified organization?	If **YES**, you must have a written record from that particular organization, and then go to Step 14. If **NO**, go to Step 14.
step 14	Did you make a noncash donation to a qualified organization? N**ote:** Generally the value of a donation is the lesser of your cost or fair market value.	If **YES**, advise the taxpayer that generally he or she must have a written receipt from that particular organization. Go to Step 15. See **Note 2**. If **NO**, Go to Step 15.
step 15	Is the total of all noncash donations $500 or less?	If **YES**, see Publication 17 for more details. If **NO**, this is beyond the scope of VITA/TCE. Refer taxpayer to a professional tax preparer.

Note 1: If you refinanced in an earlier year, and weren't eligible to take all the points in that year, you can add in this year's portion of those prior year points.

Note 2: For noncash donations less than $250, you are not required to have a receipt where it is impractical to get one (for example if you leave property at a charity's unattended drop site).

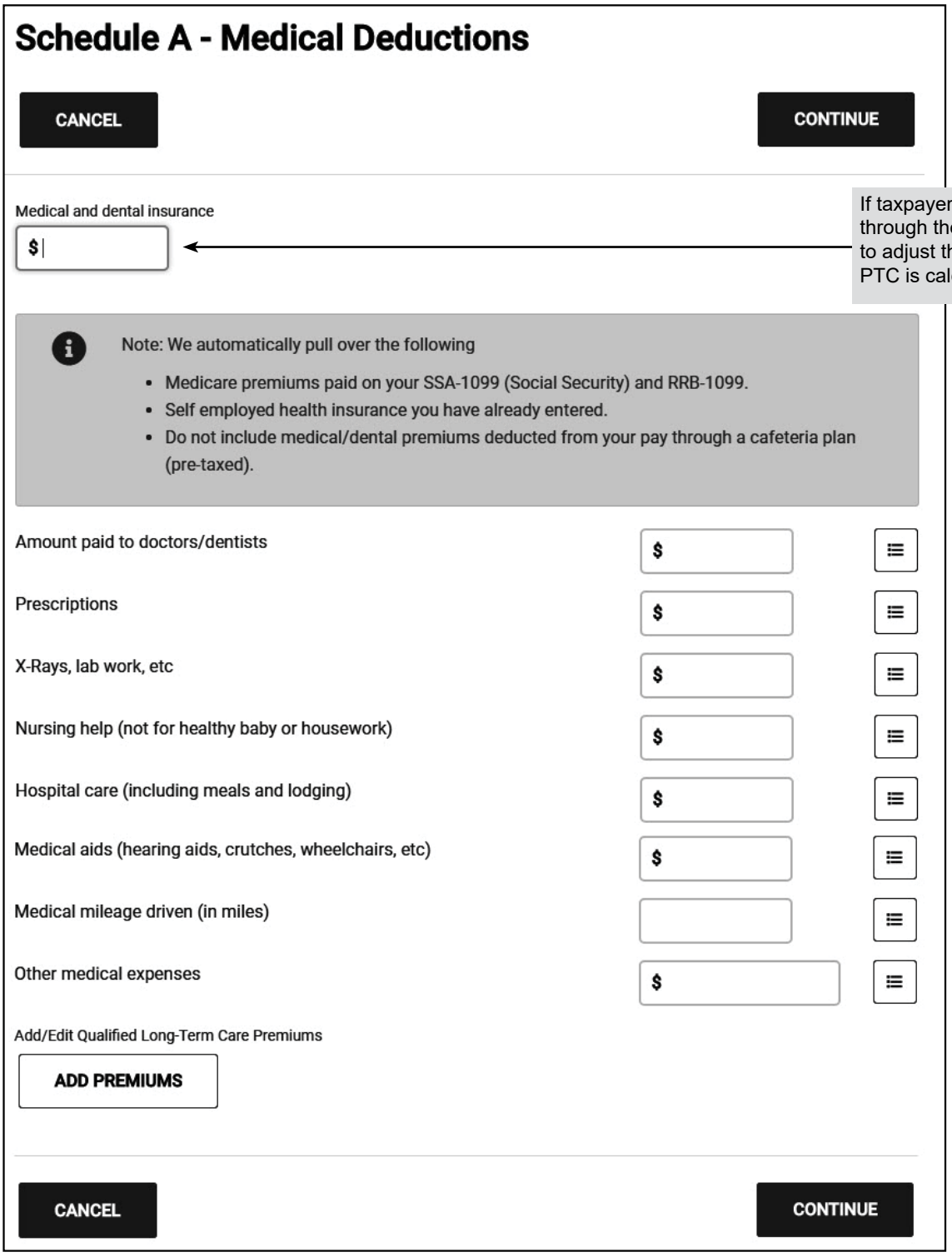
Schedule A – Itemized Deductions

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Medical and Dental Expenses



Schedule A Deductible and Nondeductible Medical Expenses	
You can include:	**You can't include:**
• Bandages • Birth control pills prescribed by your doctor • Body scan • Braille books • Breast pump and supplies • Capital expenses for equipment or improvements to your home needed for medical care (see Worksheet A, Capital Expense Worksheet, in Pub. 502) • Diagnostic devices • Expenses of an organ donor • Eye surgery (to promote the correct function of the eye) • Fertility enhancement, certain procedures • Guide dogs or other animals aiding the blind, deaf, and disabled • Hospital services fees (lab work, therapy, nursing services, surgery, etc.) • Lead-based paint removal • Legal abortion • Legal operation to prevent having children such as a vasectomy or tubal ligation • Long-term care contracts, qualified • Meals and lodging provided by a hospital during medical treatment • Medical services fees (from doctors, dentists, surgeons, specialists, and other medical practitioners) • Medicare Part D premiums • Medical and hospital insurance premiums • Nursing services • Oxygen equipment and oxygen • Part of life-care fee paid to retirement home designated for medical care • Physical examination • Pregnancy test kit • Prescription medicines (prescribed by a doctor) and insulin • Psychiatric and psychological treatment • Social security tax, Medicare tax, FUTA, and state employment tax for worker providing medical care (see Wages for nursing services below) • Special items (artificial limbs, false teeth, eyeglasses, contact lenses, hearing aids, crutches, wheelchair, etc.) • Special education for mentally or physically disabled persons • Stop-smoking programs • Transportation for needed medical care • Treatment at a drug or alcohol center (includes meals and lodging provided by the center) • Wages for nursing services • Weight loss, certain expenses for obesity	• Baby sitting and childcare • Bottled water • Contributions to Archer MSAs (see Pub. 969) • Diaper service • Expenses for your general health (even if following your doctor's advice) such as——Health club dues—Household help (even if recommended by a doctor)—Social activities, such as dancing or swimming lessons—Trip for general health improvement • Flexible spending account reimbursements for medical expenses (if contributions were on a pre-tax basis) • Funeral, burial, or cremation expenses • Health savings account payments for medical expenses • Operation, treatment, or medicine that is illegal under federal or state law • Life insurance or income protection policies, or policies providing payment for loss of life, limb, sight, etc. • Maternity clothes • Medical insurance included in a car insurance policy covering all persons injured in or by your car • Medicine you buy without a prescription • Nursing care for a healthy baby • Prescription drugs you brought in (or ordered shipped) from another country, in most cases • Nutritional supplements, vitamins, herbal supplements, "natural medicines," etc., unless recommended by a medical practitioner as a treatment for a specific medical condition diagnosed by a physician • Surgery for purely cosmetic reasons • Toothpaste, toiletries, cosmetics, etc. • Teeth whitening • Weight-loss expenses not for the treatment of obesity or other disease CAUTION You can't include in medical expenses amounts you pay for controlled substances that aren't legal under federal law, even if such substances are legalized by state law.

Schedule A - Itemized Deductions (continued)

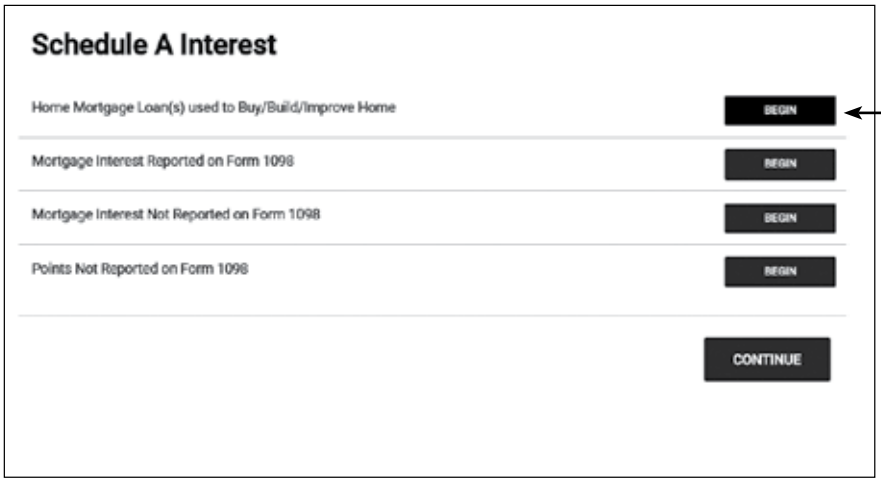


If taxpayer has medical insurance through the Marketplace, remember to adjust the total premium after the PTC is calculated.

To enter multiple expenses of a single type, click on the small calculator icon beside the line. Enter the first description, the amount, and Continue. Enter the next. They will be totaled on the input line and carry to Schedule A.

Note: Medical and dental floor percentage is 7.5%. Some senior residences (nursing homes) have an amount in the monthly cost which is a medical expense. Taxpayers can include in medical expenses the cost of medical care in a nursing home, home for the aged or similar institution. This includes the cost of meals and lodging if the principal reason for being there is to get medical care.

Schedule A - Itemized Deductions (continued)



Select for mortgage interest reported on Form 1098. Enter amount from Form 1098F, box 1 (and box 2, if applicable).

Note: The deduction for home equity debt is disallowed as a mortgage interest deduction unless the home equity debt was used to build, buy, or substantially improve the taxpayer's qualified residence.



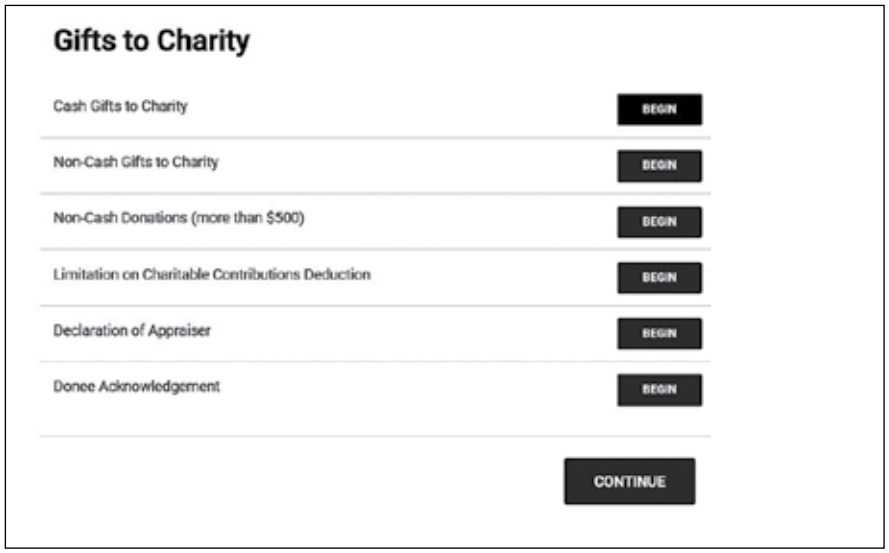


If there are multiple mortgages, make additional Schedule A Interest entries.

For mortgages entered into after December 15, 2017, the amount of interest you can deduct is on no more than $750,000 of debt used to buy, build, or substantially improve your principal home and a second home ($375,000 in the case of married taxpayers filing separate tax returns) for tax years 2018 through 2025.

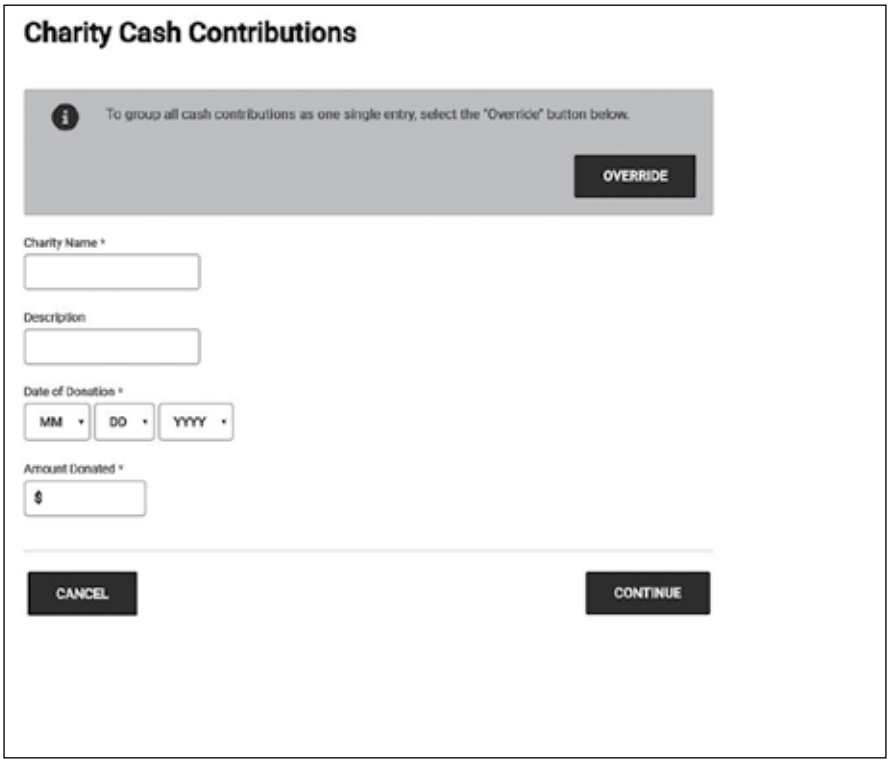
Points from refinancing must be spread over the life of the mortgage unless used to remodel (see section in Publication 17, labeled "Points"). Enter loan origination fee from closing statement as points not reported on Form 1098 if not included as points on Form 1098.

Schedule A - Itemized Deductions (continued)



Note: Enter amounts given by cash or check under Cash Gifts to Charity. The 30% & 60% refer to the percentage of your AGI that can be deducted this year. See Publication 17 for definitions. Enter the value of noncash items (including miles driven in service to a charity) donated under Noncash Gifts to Charity. Be careful to list them separately.
If noncash contributions are greater than $500, Form 8283, Noncash Charitable Contributions must be completed and this form is Out of Scope.

Certain qualified contributions made for relief efforts in disaster areas are not subject to the AGI limitation. See Publication 976, Disaster Relief.



These types of donations are not deductible: political; country club/fraternal lodge; chambers of commerce; raffle, bingo, or lottery tickets; tuition; value of time/services; gifts to lobby groups; civic leagues, social clubs; labor unions, homeowners association dues.

Nonrefundable Credits

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Deductions>Credits Menu



Hint: Nonrefundable credits can't exceed the taxpayer's federal income tax.

Form 8863

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Deductions>Credits Menu>Education Credits; or Keyword "886". For complete education credit information refer to Tab J, Education Benefits

Schedule R

If taxpayer qualifies for the credit for the elderly or the disabled, open Schedule R. Refer to the Credit for the Elderly or the Disabled - Screening Sheet later in this tab.

Child Tax Credit

This is a credit intended to reduce the tax. This part of the credit isn't refundable. The credit is up to $2,000 per qualifying child. This credit calculates automatically.

Qualifying child:

1. Under age 17 at the end of the tax year.
2. A U.S. citizen or U.S. national* or resident alien of the United States. See Tab L, Resident/NR Alien.
3. Claimed as your dependent.**
4. Your:
   a. son or daughter, adopted child, stepchild, eligible foster child, or a descendant of any of them
   b. brother, sister, half brother, half sister, stepbrother, stepsister, or a descendant of any of them (for example, your niece or nephew)
5. Didn't provide over half of his or her own support.
6. Lived with the taxpayer for more than half of the tax year. (See Exception to Time Lived with You section on the Child Tax Credit chart on the following page.)
7. Must have a Social Security Number valid for employment issued before the due date of the return.

* A National is an individual who, although not a U.S. citizen, owes his or her allegiance to the United States. U.S. nationals include American Samoans and Northern Mariana Islanders who chose to become U.S. nationals instead of U.S. citizens.

**Refer to the tables in Tab C, Dependents, for the rules governing who may be claimed as a dependent.



If the taxpayer is able to claim the dependent under the rules for divorced and separated parents, he or she is the only parent entitled to claim the child tax credit or additional child tax credit.

Additional Child Tax Credit – General Eligibility

Note: Make sure the taxpayer's credit hasn't been disallowed previously. If previously disallowed, see Form 8862, Information To Claim Certain Credits After Disallowance, in Tab I, Earned Income Credit.

The child tax credit is generally a nonrefundable credit; however, certain taxpayers may be entitled to a refundable additional child tax credit.

- Taxpayers with more than $2,500 of taxable earned income may be eligible for the additional child tax credit if they have at least one qualifying child.
- Taxpayers with three or more children may also be eligible for additional child tax credit regardless of their income.
- Limited to $1,400 per qualifying child

Schedule 8812, Additional Child Tax Credit, is used to calculate the allowable additional child tax credit.

See Tab C, Dependents, and the worksheet in the instruction booklet for additional information (including definitions and special rules relating to an adopted child, foster child, or qualifying child of more than one person).

Note: No credit or refund for an overpayment for a taxable year shall be made to a taxpayer before the 15th day of the second month following the close of the taxable year (generally February 15th) if the taxpayer claimed the EITC or additional child tax credit on the tax return.

Note: The qualifying child must have a valid social security number by the due date of the tax return (including extensions). Taxpayers may not file an amended return to retroactively claim the additional child tax credit for a qualifying child if a valid SSN for the child is issued after the due date of the tax return.

Note: You must claim the child as a dependent on your return to qualify for the child tax credit.

Note: (International Certification only) If you claim the foreign earned income exclusion, the housing exclusion, or the housing deduction on Form 2555, you can't claim the additional child tax credit.

Note: See Disallowance of Certain Credits in Tab I, Earned Income Credit, if the taxpayer received a letter saying they had to complete Form 8862.

Note: Certain taxpayers affected by a federally declared disaster area may elect to calculate their earned income credit (EIC) and additional child tax credit (ACTC) by substituting their earned income from the preceding taxable year if more than the year of the applicable qualified disaster.

Table 1: Child Tax Credit

Remember to apply the steps for each dependent. To claim the child tax credit and/or the credit for other dependents, you can't be a dependent of another taxpayer.

Probe/Action: Ask the taxpayer:

step 1	Is this person your son, daughter, adopted child, stepchild, foster child, brother, sister, half brother, half sister, stepbrother, stepsister, or a descendant of any of them (for example, your grandchild, niece, or nephew)? A descendant is of any generation.	If **YES**, go to Step 2. If **NO**, you can't claim the child tax credit for this person. This person may qualify for the credit for other dependents, go to Table 2.
step 2	Did this person provide over half of his or her own support for the tax year?	If **NO**, go to Step 3. If **YES**, you can't claim the child tax credit or the credit for other dependents for this person. STOP if the taxpayer has no other dependents.
step 3	Did this person live with you for more than half of the tax year? If the dependent didn't live with you for the required time, see the following notes below the chart: • Exception to Time Lived with You • Kidnapped Child • Children of Divorced or Separated Parents or Parents who live apart.	If **YES**, go to Step 4. If **NO**, you can't claim the child tax credit for this person. This person may qualify for the credit for other dependents, go to Table 2.
step 4	Is this person a U.S. citizen, U.S. national, or resident alien of the United States? Note: A national is an individual who, although not a U.S. citizen, owes his or her allegiance to the United States. U.S. nationals include American Samoans and Northern Mariana Islanders who chose to become U.S. nationals instead of U.S. citizens. See Tab L, Resident/NR Alien for definition of Resident Alien.	If **YES**, go to Step 5. If **NO**, you can't claim the child tax credit or the credit for other dependents for this person.
step 5	Does this person have a Social Security Number valid for employment issued before the due date of the return (including extensions)?	If **YES**, go to Step 6. If **NO**, you can't claim the child tax credit for this person. This person qualifies for the credit for other dependents if he or she has an ATIN or ITIN.
step 6	Is this person under age 17 at the end of the tax year?	If **YES**, go to Step 7 If **NO**, you can't claim the child tax credit for this person. This person qualifies for the credit for other dependents.

Questions: Who Must Use Publication 972, Child Tax Credit?

step 7	Are you excluding income from Puerto Rico or are you filing Form 2555 (relating to foreign earned income), or Form 4563, Exclusion of Income for Bona Fide Residents of American Samoa?	If **NO**, go to Step 8. If **YES**, you must use Publication 972 to figure the credit.
step 8	Are you claiming any of the following credits? • Adoption Credit, a residential energy credit, Form 5695, Part II; Mortgage Interest credit, Form 8396; District of Columbia first-time homebuyer credit, Form 8859.	If **NO**, use the Child Tax Credit Worksheet to figure the credit. If **YES**, you must use Publication 972 to figure the credit.

Exception to Time Lived with You
A child is considered to have lived with you for all of the current tax year if the child was born or died in 2019 and your home was this child's home for more than half the time he or she was alive. Temporary absences for special circumstances, such as for school, vacation, medical care, military service, or detention in a juvenile facility, count as time lived at home.

Kidnapped Child
A kidnapped child is considered to have lived with you for all of the current tax year if:
- In the year the kidnapping occurred, the kidnapped child is presumed by law enforcement to have been taken by someone who isn't a family member, and
- The kidnapped child lived with the taxpayer for more than half of the portion of the year prior to the kidnapping.

Modified Adjusted Gross Income Limits
- Married filing jointly - $400,000
- All other filing statuses - $200,000

Note: Current tax year reference applies to tax year 2019.

Children of Divorced or Separated Parents
A child will be treated as being the qualifying child of his or her noncustodial parent if all of the following apply:
- The parents were divorced or legally separated or lived apart at all times during the last 6 months of the current tax year.
- The child received over half of his or her support for the current tax year from the parents.
- The child was in the custody of one or both of the parents for more than half of the current tax year.
- The custodial parent signs Form 8332, Release/Revocation of Release of Claim to Exemption for Child by Custodial Parent, or similar statement that he or she won't claim the child as a dependent in the current tax year and the noncustodial parent includes a copy of the form or statement with his or her return. If the divorce decree or separation agreement went into effect after 1984 and before 2009, the noncustodial parent may be able to attach certain pages of the decree or agreement instead of Form 8332. For pre-1985 divorces, see the Instructions for Form 1040.

Credit for Other Dependents

There is a $500 credit for other dependents who do not qualify for the $2,000 child tax credit. The dependent must be a U.S citizen, U.S. national, or resident of the U.S. The dependent must have a valid identification number (ATIN, ITIN, or SSN).

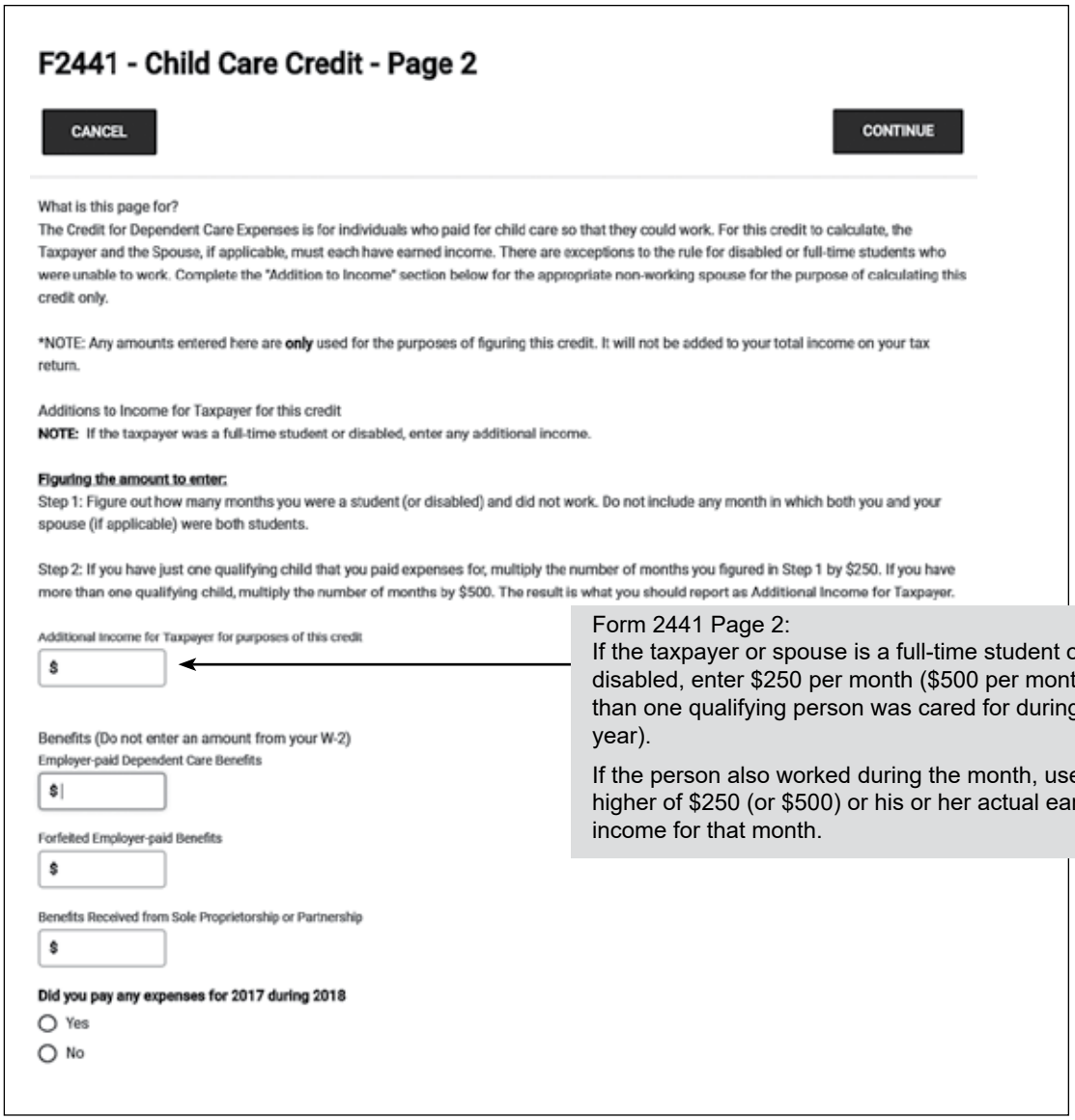
The $500 nonrefundable credit is available for dependents who don't qualify for the child tax credit, such as children who are age 17 and above, dependents with other relationships (such as elderly parents), or children who do not have a valid SSN. Taxpayers cannot claim the credit for themselves (or a spouse if Married Filing Jointly).



Dependents who are not U.S. citizens or U.S. nationals, but are residents of Canada or Mexico do not qualify for either the Child Tax Credit or the Credit for Other Dependents.

Note: If previously disallowed, see Form 8862, Information To Claim Certain Credits After Disallowance, in Tab I, Earned Income Credit.

Form 2441 – Credit for Child and Dependent Care Expenses (continued)



Form 2441 Page 2:
If the taxpayer or spouse is a full-time student or disabled, enter $250 per month ($500 per month if more than one qualifying person was cared for during the year).

If the person also worked during the month, use the higher of $250 (or $500) or his or her actual earned income for that month.

CAUTION Only enter dependent care benefits not reported on a Form W-2

Note: Foreign earned income and the foreign housing exclusion are subtracted from wages when figuring the credit. Subtract any amount earned while incarcerated or on work release.

Note: Both spouses must have earned income in order to claim the credit. Complete the additions to income for taxpayer if the taxpayer or spouse was either a full-time student or disabled. If the taxpayer has a filing status of surviving spouse, the amount from line 4 is entered on line 5.

Retirement Savings Contributions Credit – Screening Sheet

To determine if a taxpayer qualifies for the Credit for Qualified Retirement Savings Contributions, review the return information and ask the taxpayer the following:

step 1	Did you make a voluntary contribution or deferral to an IRA or other qualified plan for 2019?[1]	**YES** – Go to Step 2 **NO** – Not qualified for credit
step 2	Is AGI $32,000 or less ($48,000 if head of household, $64,000 if married filing jointly)?	**YES** – Go to Step 3 **NO** – Not qualified for credit
step 3	Were you born before January 2, 2002?	**YES** – Go to Step 4 **NO** – Not qualified for credit
step 4	Are you being claimed as a dependent on someone else's tax return for 2019?	**YES** – Not qualified for credit **NO** – Go to Step 5
step 5	Were you a full-time student[2] during 2019?	**YES** – Not qualified for credit **NO** – Qualified for credit

Footnotes

[1] Plans that qualify are listed in the Other Credits chapter of Publication 17. Answer yes if the taxpayer will make a qualifying IRA contribution for tax year 2019 by the due date of the return.

[2] You were a student if during any part of 5 calendar months of 2019 you:
- Were enrolled as a full-time student at a school, or
- Took a full-time, on-farm training course given by a school* or a state, county, or local government agency.

*A school includes technical, trade and mechanical schools. It does not include on-the job training courses, correspondence schools, or schools offering courses only through the Internet.

Important Reminders for Retirement Savings Contributions Credit

- Be sure to look at the taxpayer's Form(s) W-2. An entry in box 12 or an "X" in the Retirement box is an indicator that the taxpayer may be eligible for this credit. A full description of all codes used in box 12 can be found in Instructions for Forms W-2 and W-3.
- An entry in box 14 on the Form W-2 may also indicate a contribution to a state retirement system. In TaxSlayer, if the contribution qualifies, from the drop down menu in Box 14 of Form W-2, select **Retirement (Not in Box 12) Carry to Form 8880**. If these are treated as employer contributions they aren't eligible for the credit. See Instructions for Form W-2.
- When using tax software, remember to key in all entries as they appear on the Form W-2.
- A contribution to a Traditional or Roth IRA qualifies for this credit, but may not appear on any taxpayer document. Remember to review the expenses section on page 2 of the Form 13614-C, Intake/Interview & Quality Review Sheet, and ask taxpayers if they made any IRA contributions.
- Some distributions reduce the eligible contributions for this credit. In addition to distributions for the current year as shown on Forms 1099-R, be sure to ask about distributions from the 2 prior years or between January 1 and the tax filing deadline.
- See a list of distributions later in this tab that don't reduce the eligible contributions for this credit.
- Form 8880, Credit for Qualified Retirement Savings Contributions, is used to claim this credit.
- If taxpayer (or spouse if MFJ) is a full-time student, be sure to mark it in the Personal Information Section in the software. This credit is not available to full-time students.

Other Taxes and Payments

TIP TaxSlayer provides all the forms and schedules you need in order to figure and report these taxes, and in most cases, performs the calculations.



Self-Employment Tax –

Entered automatically from Schedule SE. TaxSlayer calculates the amount using the entries from Schedule C.

Unreported Social Security and Medicare Tax –

Unreported Social Security and Medicare Tax comes from Form 4137, Social Security and Medicare Tax on Unreported Tip Income, not reported on Form W-2.

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Income>Wages and Salaries>Unreported tips (on W-2 below line 10); or Keyword “W”. If unreported because tips were less than $20 per month, Federal Section>Other Taxes>Tax on Unreported Tip Income; or Keyword “4137”

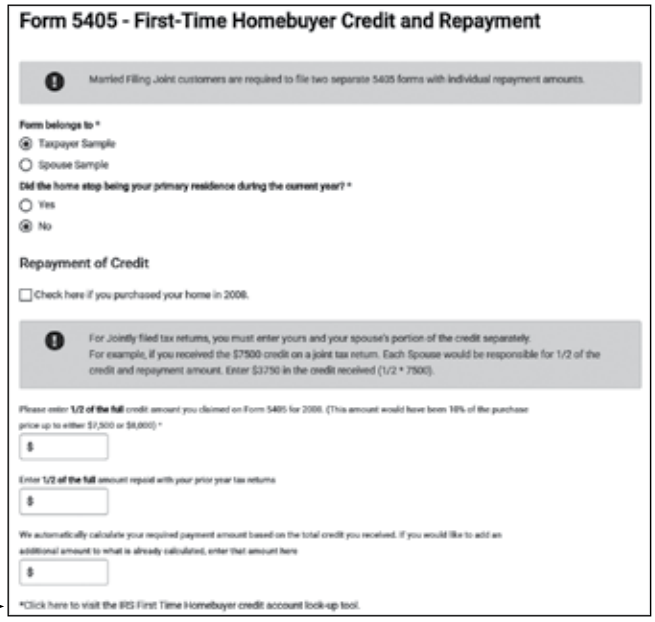
Other Taxes and Payments (continued)

Repayment of First-Time Homebuyer Credit Form 5405 –

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Other Taxes>First-Time Homebuyer Repayment; or Keyword “FIR”

Taxpayers who purchased a home in 2008 and received the First Time Homebuyer Credit (maximum $7,500 loan) started repayments in 2010 and must enter the repayment on Form 5405, Repayment of the First-Time Homebuyer Credit. (See 5405 instructions for when it is required.)

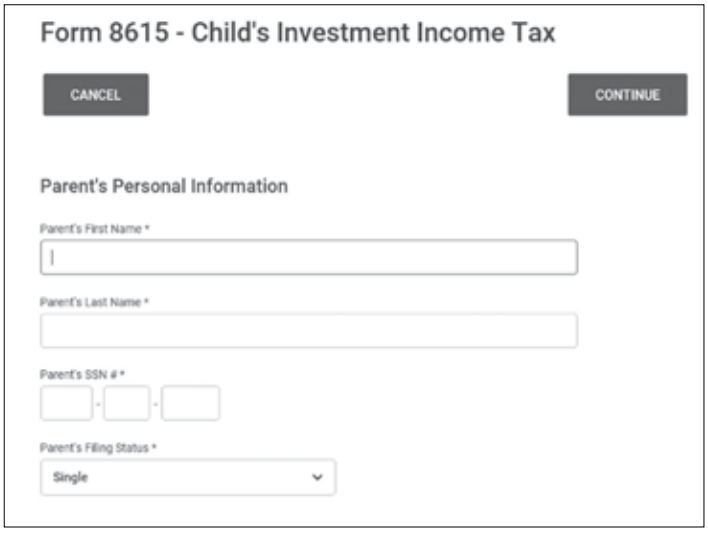
Use the First-Time Homebuyer Credit Account Look-up tool on irs.gov to determine the amount of the repayment.



TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Other Taxes>Tax for Children Under 18

Tax for Children who Have Unearned Income

If the student includes the tax free educational assistance in income, has a filing requirement and unearned income (including the taxable scholarship) over $2,200, the student will be subject to filing Form 8615, Tax for Certain Children Who Have Unearned Income (Kiddie Tax) to compute the tax. (See the following page.)



Note: This is in scope but limited to students electing to include unearned income such as scholarships/grants as income on the return.

Further Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2020 changed the tax rate used in calculation of the kiddie tax. It applies to taxable years beginning after December 31, 2019. A taxpayer may elect to apply this calculation to taxable years 2018, 2019, or both. The taxpayer may benefit from making this election. If the taxpayer makes this election, the return is out of scope.

Other Taxes and Payments (continued)

Do you have to use Form 8615 to figure your child's tax?

step 1	Was the child's unearned income more than $2,200?	**YES** – Go to Step 2 **NO** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax.
step 2	Is the child required to file a tax return for 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 3 **NO** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax.
step 3	Was the child under age 18 at the end of 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 8 **NO** – Go to Step 4
step 4	Was the child age 18 at the end of 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 7 **NO** – Go to Step 5
step 5	Was the child under age 24 at the end of 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 6 **NO** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax.
step 6	Was the child a full-time student in 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 7 **NO** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax.
step 7	Did the child have earned income that was more than half of his or her support?	**YES** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax. **NO** – Go to Step 8
step 8	Was at least one of the child's parents alive at the end of 2019?	**YES** – Go to Step 9 **NO** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax.
step 9	Is the child filing a joint return for 2019?	**YES** – Don't use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax. **NO** – Go to Step 10
step 10	Use Form 8615 to figure the child's tax. Attach it to the child's return.	

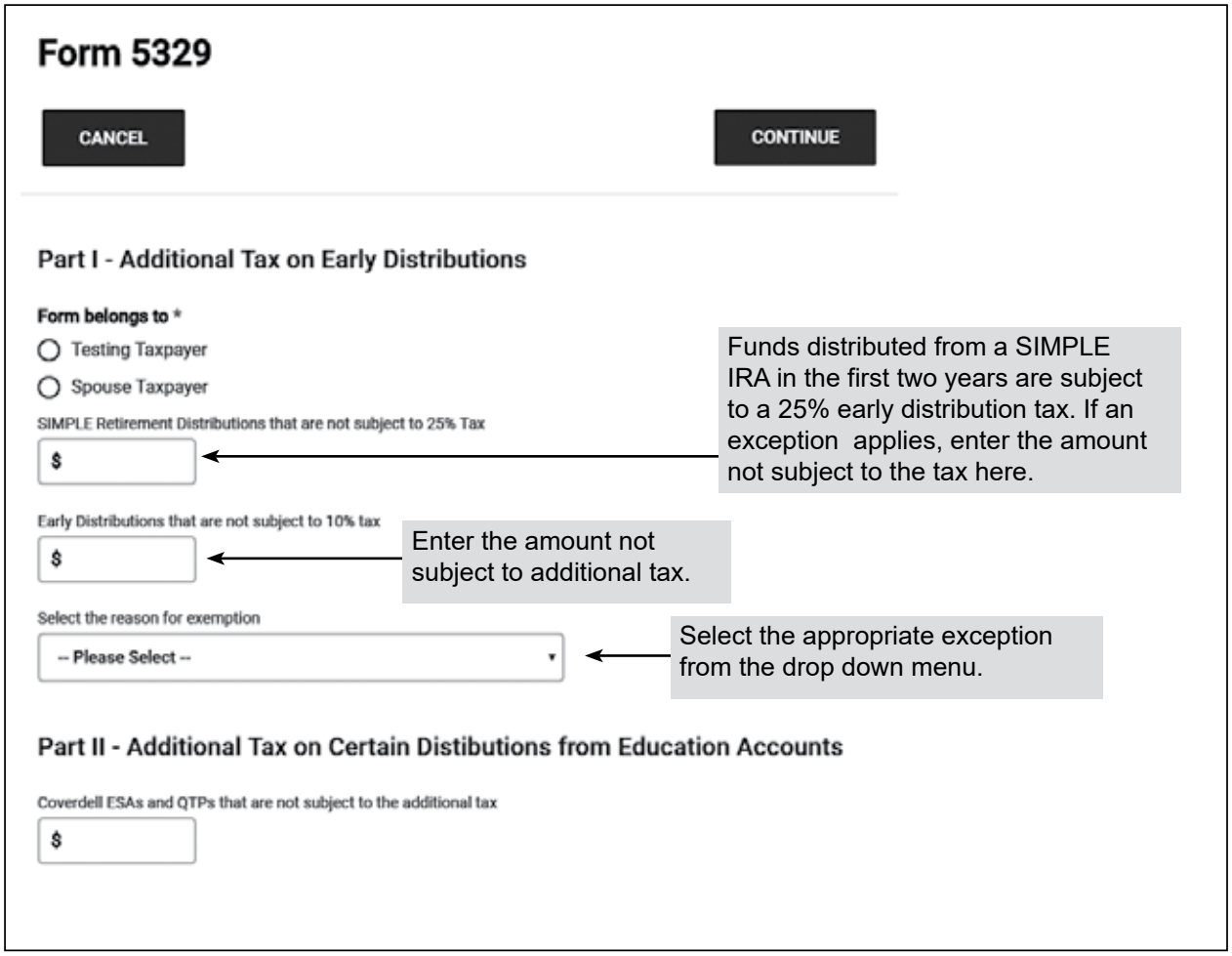
Note: If the child's parent chooses to report the child's income by filing Form 8814, the child isn't required to file a tax return. Don't use Form 8615. (See Parent's Election to Report Child's Interest and Dividends.) Form 8814 is out of scope.

Other Taxes and Payments (continued)

Additional Tax on IRA's and Other Qualified Plans –

TaxSlayer Navigation: Federal Section>Other Taxes>Tax on Early distribution; or Keyword "5329"

A 10% penalty is calculated on Form 5329, Additional Tax on Qualified Plans (Including IRAs) and Other Tax-Favored Accounts, for early withdrawal before age 59-1/2. If an exception applies, enter the code and the amount on line 2 of Form 5329.



Other Taxes and Payments (continued)

Exception codes and explanations for early distributions from IRAs or retirement plans:

(Do not rely on this list alone. See Publication 590-B, Distributions from Individual Retirement Arrangements (IRAs), for rules and details pertaining to each exception.)

No	Exception
01	Qualified retirement plan distributions (doesn't apply to IRAs) if you separated from service in or after the year you reach age 55 (age 50 for qualified public safety employees).
02	Distributions made as part of a series of substantially equal periodic payments (made at least annually) for your life (or life expectancy) or the joint lives (or joint life expectancies) of you and your designated beneficiary (if from an employer plan, payments must begin after separation from service).
03	Distributions due to total and permanent disability. Does not apply if the disability occurred after the distribution.
04	Distributions due to death (doesn't apply to modified endowment contracts).
05	Qualified retirement plan distributions up to (1) the amount you paid for unreimbursed medical expenses during the year minus (2) 7.5% of your adjusted gross income for the year.
06	Qualified retirement plan distributions made to an alternate payee under a qualified domestic relations order (doesn't apply to IRAs).
07	IRA distributions made to unemployed individuals for health insurance premiums.[1]
08	IRA distributions made for qualified higher education expenses.
09	IRA distributions made for purchase of a first home, up to $10,000.
10	Distributions due to an IRS levy on the qualified retirement plan.
11	Qualified distributions to reservists while serving on active duty for at least 180 days.
12	Other [2]. Also, enter this code if more than one exception applies.

Footnotes

[1] Medical insurance for yourself, your spouse, and your dependents (no 7.5% of AGI reduction). All of the following conditions must apply:

- You lost your job.
- You received unemployment compensation paid under any federal or state law for 12 consecutive weeks because you lost your job.
- You receive the distributions during either the year you received the unemployment compensation or the following year.
- You receive the distributions no later than 60 days after you have been reemployed.

[2] Distributions incorrectly indicated as early distributions by code 1, J, or S in box 7 of Form 1099-R. Include on line 2 the amount you received when you were age 59 1/2 or older. See Form 5329 Instructions or Publication 590-B for additional exceptions. For additional exceptions that apply to annuities, see Publication 575, Pensions and Annuity Income.

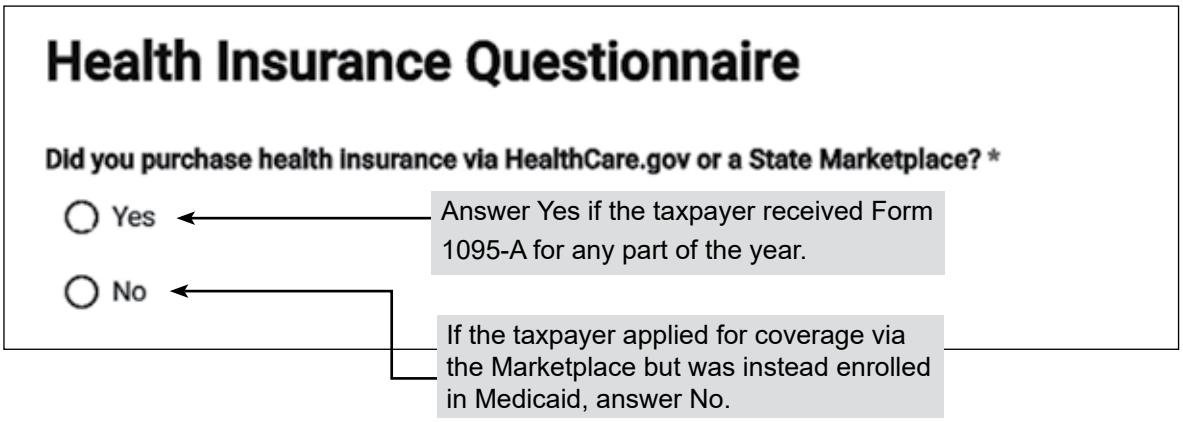
Additional Taxes on HSAs

For those with HSA certification only. Additional taxes for HSA distributions not used for qualified medical expenses are reported on Form 1040 Schedule 2. All other taxes on this line are Out of Scope. See Instructions for Form 8889, Health Savings Accounts (HSAs).

The additional 20% tax does not apply to distributions made after the account beneficiary:

- Dies,
- Becomes disabled, or
- Turns age 65

Affordable Care Act (ACA)



A Yes answer will require entry of information from Form 1095-A. See Premium Tax Credit section later in this tab for help entering Form 1095-A.

TIP If taxpayers answer No, no further action is necessary.

Earned Income Table

Earned Income for EIC	
Includes	**Doesn't include**
• Taxable wages, salaries, and tips • Union strike benefits • Taxable long-term disability benefits received prior to minimum retirement age • Net earnings from self-employment • Gross income of a statutory employee • Household employee income • Nontaxable combat pay election • Nonemployee compensation • The rental value of a home or a housing allowance provided to a minister as part of the minister's pay (Out of Scope)	• Interest and dividends • Social Security and railroad retirement benefits • Welfare benefits • Workfare payments • Pensions and annuities (except if disability pension and taxpayer is under minimum retirement age) • Veteran's benefits (including VA rehabilitation payments) • Workers' compensation benefits • Alimony • Child support • Nontaxable foster-care payments • Unemployment compensation • Taxable scholarship or fellowship grants that aren't reported on Form W-2 • Earnings for work performed while an inmate at a penal institution or on work release* • Salary deferrals (for example, under a 401(k) or 403(b) plan or the Federal Thrift Savings Plan) • The value of meals or lodging provided by an employer for the convenience of the employer • Disability Insurance payments • Excludable dependent care benefits (line 25 of Form 2441) • Salary reductions such as under a cafeteria plan • Excludable employer-provided educational assistance benefits (may be shown in box 14 of Form W-2)

*This particular income is entered as other income on the return and not counted as earned income.

Note: Certain taxpayers affected by a federally declared disaster area may elect to calculate their earned income credit (EIC) and additional child tax credit (ACTC) by substituting their earned income from the preceding taxable year if more than the year of the applicable qualified disaster. Search the IRS website for "Tax Relief in Disaster Situations" for more information.

Common EIC Filing Errors

- Claiming a child who doesn't meet the residency and relationship requirements
- Married taxpayers incorrectly filing as a single or head of household
- Incorrectly reporting income, particularly income and expenses from self-employment
- Incorrect Social Security numbers

Summary of EIC Eligibility Requirements

Part A Rules for Everyone	Part B Rules If You Have a Qualifying Child	Part C Rules If You Don't Have a Qualifying Child
Taxpayers & qualifying children must all have SSN that is valid for employment by the due date of the return (including extensions).[1]	Child must meet the relationship, age, residency test and joint return tests but not the support test. The child doesn't have to be your dependent.[2]	Must be at least age 25 but under age 65 as of December 31.[3]
Filing status can't be married filing separately.	Qualifying child can't be used by more than one person to claim the EIC.	Can't be the dependent of another person.
Must be a U.S. citizen or resident alien all year.	The taxpayer can't be a qualifying child of another person.	Must have lived in the United States more than half the year.
Can't file Form 2555 (relating to foreign earned income).		Can't be a qualifying child of another person.
Investment income must be $3,600 or less.		
Can't be a qualifying child of another person.		

Part D
Earned Income and AGI Limitations
You must have earned income to qualify for this credit.

Your earned income and AGI must be less than:

- $50,162 ($55,952 for married filing jointly) if you have three or more qualifying children,
- $46,703 ($52,493 for married filing jointly) if you have two qualifying children,
- $41,094 ($46,884 for married filing jointly) if you have one qualifying child, or
- $15,570 ($21,370 for married filing jointly) if you don't have a qualifying child.

Footnotes

[1] If your Social Security card says "VALID FOR WORK ONLY WITH DHS AUTHORIZATION," you can use your Social Security number to claim EIC if you otherwise qualify.
If taxpayer (or spouse, if filing a joint return) or dependent has an individual taxpayer identification number (ITIN), they can't get the EIC. ITINs are issued by the IRS to noncitizens who can't get an SSN.
If the taxpayer's Social Security card has a "NOT VALID FOR EMPLOYMENT" imprint, and if the card-holder obtained the SSN to get a federally funded benefit, such as Medicaid, they can't get the EIC.

[2] To meet the joint return test, the child cannot file a joint return for the year unless it's only to claim a refund of income tax withheld or estimated tax paid.

[3] Taxpayers turning 25 on January 1st are considered to be 25 as of December 31st. Taxpayers reaching the age 65 on January 1st are still considered to be 64 as of December 31st.



Taxpayers cannot file an amended return to claim the credit for a year they did not originally have a valid Social Security number.

Income – Key Highlights (continued)

- To enter Taxable Scholarship, Prisoner Earned Income, or Foreign Compensation, select **Other Compensation** on the W-2 Menu.
- Interest/ Dividend Income will be entered from either Income Menu Option 2 or 3 depending on the amount of the income. If you start with option 3 (less than $1500) and then put any amount using option 2 (Sch B), any amounts input under option 3 are ignored and lost.
- Private activity bond interest (PAB) is entered in Other Taxes>> Alternative Minimum Tax>>Interest from specified private activity bonds exempt from the regular tax.
- The Schedule C can be accessed through Option 6 of the main Income menu. Remember to enter the Principal Business Activity Code on the Schedule C.
- When entering gross receipts, this would include income reported on Form 1099-K, Payment Card and Third-Party Network Transactions, as well as all other cash and any other income received related to the business activity.
- To enter Schedule D, Capital Gains and Losses, select Option 7 from the main Income menu and then enter the transactions. Select the Other menu button in the Edit Capital Gain/Loss Transactions screen to enter capital loss carryovers and to access the Sale of Home worksheet. See Tab D, Income, for more information on Capital Gains/ Losses.
- If an adjustment to basis or net capital gain is required, enter the adjustment amount and select the adjustment code(s) from the list. For most transactions, no adjustment to gain or loss is needed. You may need to enter an adjustment if the basis provided is incorrect, another situation applies that requires a change to the basis, or if the taxpayer is able to exclude some or all of the capital gain.
- To use the Simplified Method, check the box labeled “SGR” in Box 2A of Form 1099-R, Distributions from Pensions, Annuities, Retirement or Profit-Sharing Plans, IRAs, Insurance Contracts, etc.
- To enter other income that is not already listed in the Other Income Menu box, select Option 1 and then enter the income.

Income – Key Highlights (continued)

Public Safety Exclusions

To enter the amount of the health insurance exclusion for a Public Safety Officer (PSO), from the Main Menu of the Tax Return (Form 1040)

1. Select **Income Menu**
2. Select **IRA/Pension Distributions (Form 1099-R/RRB, SSA)**
3. Select **New** and fill out the Payer's Information
4. Enter the Gross Distribution in Box 1 as it is shown on the 1099-R
5. Subtract the amount of any Qualified Retired Public Safety Officer Distribution from the Gross Distribution and enter the different Taxable Amount. Exit this menu. The smaller of the amount of the premiums for health and/or long-term care (LTC) insurance or $3,000 can be excluded (subtracted) from distribution.
6. Select the **Other/Roth** Button
7. Select **Public Safety Officers Insurance Distribution**
8. Select **Yes**
9. Select the line on **Form 1040** where Form 1099-R is reported. When you view Form 1040, the abbreviation **PSO** will be displayed in the left margin.

If you selected Form 1040 wages line, you will be prompted to input the amount of distribution being excluded. The exclusion and the abbreviation PSO will print on the dotted line next to the wages amount.

Note: This is a guide on entering Public Safety Officer Distributions into TaxSlayer. This is not intended as tax advice.



Any amount exceeding $3,000 is entered on Schedule A, Itemized Deductions as insurance cost. The insurance can be for the taxpayer, spouse and family. When Form 1099-R, Box 7 is Code 4 (distribution due to death), the PSO deduction may no longer be used.

Entering Medicaid Waiver Payments (that may be excluded from income under Notice 2014-7):

Scenario A: If income is reported on Form W-2, enter the amount as provided. Then, enter the amount in the Medicaid Waiver Payment box on the Form W-2 entry screen to exclude it.

Scenario B: If income is reported on Form 1099-MISC, Miscellaneous Income, and you are not in the business of providing home care services, go to Other income not reported elsewhere and enter IRS Notice 2014-7 in the description field and $0 in the amount field.

Scenario C: If income is reported on Form 1099-MISC and you are in the business of providing home care services, enter the full amount of payments under Gross Receipts in the Schedule C Income section. In Other Expenses, enter Notice 2014-7 as the description and the amount as a positive number. You cannot exclude gross receipts that are not Notice 2014-7 Medicaid waiver payments.

Navigating TaxSlayer (continued)

Form or Topic	Keyword	Navigation to Data Entry Screen	Pub 4012 Page
ITIN, Application for	N/A	Miscellaneous Forms>Application for ITIN	L-3
IRA Contributions (Traditional IRA)	IRA	Deductions>Adjustments>IRA Deduction	E-9
IRA Contributions (ROTH IRA)	RETIRE	Deductions>Credits Menu>Retirement Savings Credit>Enter Any Current Year Traditional or Roth IRA Contributions (Do not re-enter Traditional IRA contributions already reported in the IRA Deduction menu)	E-9
IRA Distributions	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions>Add or Edit a 1099-R	D-32
IRA Qualified Charitable Distribution (Not a Charitable Gift Annuity)	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distribution>Add or edit 1099-R>Subtract distribution that was sent directly by trustee to charity from Box 1 and enter the difference in Box 2a. Click continue and navigate back to Income>IRA/Pension Distribution>Go to Nontaxable Distributions> and check the box “Check here to mark this as a Qualified Charitable Distribution (QCD) on your return.”	D-32
IRA Rollover	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions> Add or Edit a 1099-R>check the box “Check here if all/part of the distribution was rolled over and enter the rollover amount.”	D-37
Jury Duty Pay	N/A	Income>Other Income>Other Income Not Reported Elsewhere	D-51
Jury Duty Paid to the Employer	J	Deductions>Adjustments>Other Adjustments>Jury Duty Pay	E-1
Lump Sum Social Security Benefit	SSA	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions>Social Security Benefits/ RRB-1099>Begin Worksheet	D-44
Medical and Dental Expenses	MED	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Medical and Dental Expenses	F-5
Medicaid Waiver Payments on W-2 (that may be excluded from income under Notice 2014-7)	W	Income>Wages and Salaries>enter the amount in the box titled “Medicaid Waiver Payment in Box 1” below box 13 (this amount will be subtracted on Schedule 1).	D-58
Mileage for Charitable Travel	CHA	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Gifts to Charity>Noncash Gifts to Charity	F-10
Mileage for Medical Travel	MED	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Medical and Dental Expenses	F-6
Mortgage Interest and Points Paid	MORT	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Mortgage Interest and Expenses>Mortgage Interest Reported on Form 1098	F-9
Mortgage Interest Paid—not on Form 1098	MORT	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Mortgage Interest and Expenses>Mortgage Interest Not Reported on Form 1098	F-9
Noncash Donations that total $500 or less	CHA	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Gifts to Charity>Noncash Gifts to Charity	F-10
OID Interest	INT	Income>Interest and Dividends>Interest or Dividend Income	D-7
Other Income (prizes, jury duty, etc.)	N/A	Income>Other Income>Other Income Not Reported Elsewhere	D-51

Navigating TaxSlayer (continued)

Form or Topic	Keyword	Navigation to Data Entry Screen	Pub 4012 Page
Pension Distributions	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions> Add or Edit a 1099-R	D-32
Personal Property Taxes	Proper	Deductions>Itemized Deductions> Taxes You Paid	F-7
PIN, Identity Theft	PIN	Miscellaneous Forms>IRS Identification Pin	P-2
Private Activity Bond interest	INT	Income>Interest and Dividends>Interest or Dividend Income	D-9
Prizes and Awards	N/A	Income>Other Income>Other Income Not Reported Elsewhere	D-15
Public Safety Officer Exclusion	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions>Add or edit 1099-R>Click here for options	D-35
Real Estate Taxes	MORT	Deductions>Itemized Deductions> Mortgage Interest and Expenses>Mortgage Interest Reported on Form 1098	F-7
Refunds of State and Local Income Tax (if reportable)	G [box 2]	Income>State and Local Refunds	D-13
Retirement Savings Credit	RETI	Deductions>Credits>Retirement Savings Credit	G-14
Roth IRA Contributions	IRA	Deductions>Credits>Retirement Savings Credit>Any Current Year Roth IRA Contributions	G-15
Royalties (Simple royalties with no associated expenses)	SC	Income>Rents and Royalties	D-49
Sale of Stock	CAP	Income>Capital Gain and Losses	D-22
Sale of Main Home	CAP	Income>Capital Gain and Losses>Sale of Main Home Worksheet or use Capital Gains and Loss Items	D-28
Sales Tax Deduction	SALE or TAX	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Taxes You Paid	F-8
Schedule C	SC	Income>Profit or Loss from a Business	D-16
Scholarships and Grants;	OT or OTHER	Income>Other Income>Other compensation> Scholarships and Grants	D-57 J-1
Self-employment Income	C	Income>Profit or Loss from a Business	D-14
Seller-financed Mortgage Interest Paid	MORT	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Mortgage Interest and Expenses>Mortgage Interest Not Reported on Form 1098	
Seller-financed Mortgage Interest Received	INT	Income>Interest and Dividends>Interest or Dividend Income>Seller Financed Interest Income	D-10
Simplified Method	-R	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions>Add or edit a 1099-R>Click here for options (under box 2a Taxable Amount)	D-36
Social Security Benefits	SSA	Income>IRA/Pension Distributions> Social Security Benefits/ RRB-1099	D-43
Taxable Refund Worksheet or State and Local Tax Refund Worksheet	G [box 2]	Income>State and Local Refunds	D-13
State and Local Taxes Paid	STAT	Deductions>Itemized Deductions>Taxes You Paid> Additional State and Local Income Tax	F-8

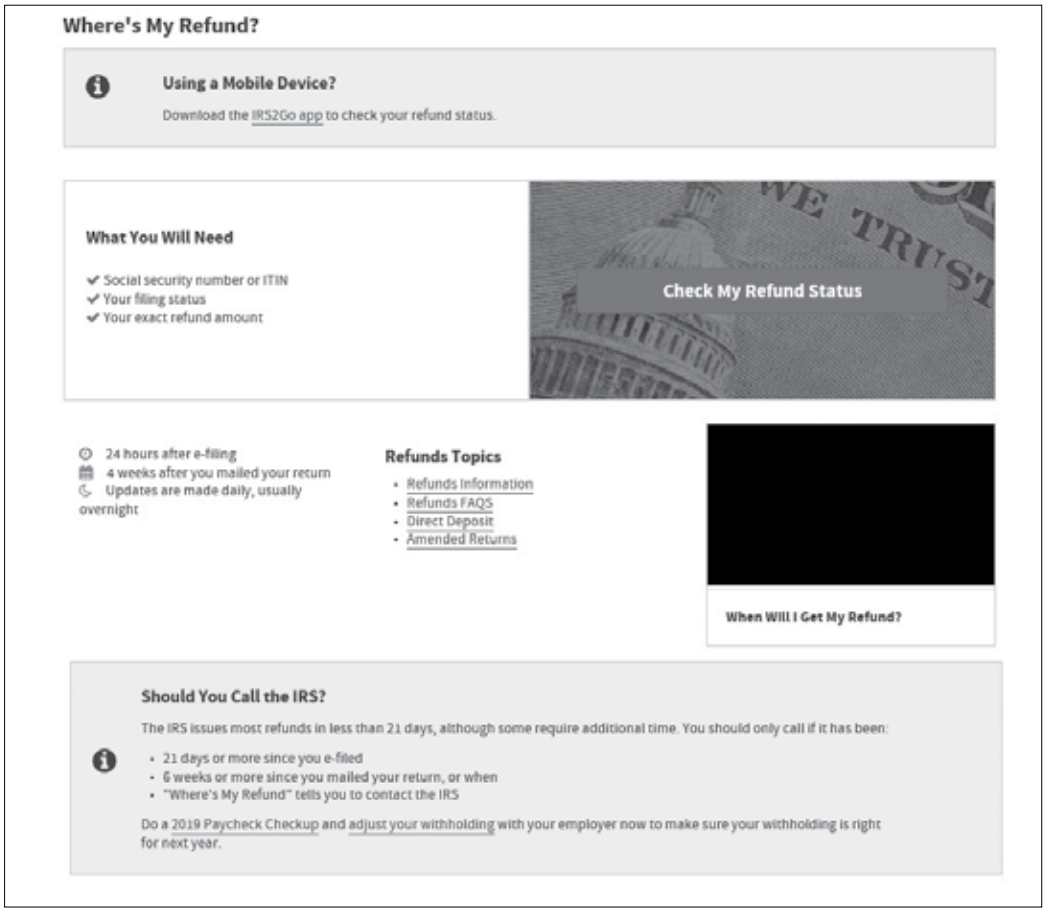
Where Do You File? Mail your return to the address shown below that applies to you. If you want to use a private delivery service, see *Private Delivery Services* under *Filing Requirements,* earlier.

TIP *Envelopes without enough postage will be returned to you by the post office. Your envelope may need additional postage if it contains more than five pages or is oversized (for example, it is over 1/4" thick). Also, include your complete return address.*

IF you live in...	THEN use this address if you: Are requesting a refund or are not enclosing a check or money order...	THEN use this address if you: Are enclosing a check or money order...
Alabama, North Carolina, South Carolina	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Kansas City, MO 64999-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 1214 Charlotte, NC 28201-1214
Alaska, California, Hawaii, Washington	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Fresno, CA 93888-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 7704 San Francisco, CA 94120-7704
Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Kansas, Montana, Nebraska, New Mexico, Nevada, North Dakota, Oregon, South Dakota, Utah, Wyoming	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Ogden, UT 84201-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 802501 Cincinnati, OH 45280-2501
Arkansas, Georgia, Indiana, Iowa, Kentucky, Missouri, New Jersey, Oklahoma, Tennessee, Virginia	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Kansas City, MO 64999-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 931000 Louisville, KY 40293-1000
Connecticut, District of Columbia, Maryland, Rhode Island, West Virginia	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Ogden, UT 84201-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 931000 Louisville, KY 40293-1000
Delaware, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New York, Vermont	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Kansas City, MO 64999-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 37008 Hartford, CT 06176-7008
Florida, Louisiana, Mississippi, Texas	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Austin, TX 73301-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 1214 Charlotte, NC 28201-1214
Illinois, Michigan, Minnesota, Ohio, Wisconsin	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Fresno, CA 93888-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 802501 Cincinnati, OH 45280-2501
Pennsylvania	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Ogden, UT 84201-0002	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 37008 Hartford, CT 06176-7008
A foreign country, U.S. possession or territory*, or use an APO or FPO address, or file Form 2555 or 4563, or are a dual-status alien	Department of the Treasury Internal Revenue Service Austin, TX 73301-0215	Internal Revenue Service P.O. Box 1303 Charlotte, NC 28201-1303

*If you live in American Samoa, Puerto Rico, Guam, the U.S. Virgin Islands, or the Northern Mariana Islands, see Pub. 570.

Where's My Refund



Interactive Tax Assistant (ITA)

The ITA tool is a tax law resource that takes you through a series of questions and provides you with responses to tax law questions on a limited number of topics. Enter "ITA" into the Search feature on the IRS website.

- Simply answer the questions and select **Continue** to progress to the next question screen.
- You may need to collect information before the interview such as income amounts, taxes owed and credits you are claiming.
- The tool includes a crossover feature that allows you to move from certain tax topics to another without needing to enter the same answers multiple times. The Review/Start Over buttons allows you to adjust responses to previously asked questions.
- When you reach the response screen, you have the option to print the entire interview and the final response.

ITA Topics by Category

Premium Tax Credit, Filing Requirement, Form to Use, Due Date, Filing Status, Dependents and Exemptions, Retirement: Pensions, IRAs, Social Security, Other Income, Deductions, Itemized Deductions, Credits, and Additional Topics (ITINs, Injured Spouse Claims, Cancellation of Debt on a Personal Residence, and Estimated Tax Payments)

For additional information on tax law resource tools, refer to the IRS website, keywords "Tax Trails" and "Tax Topics."